Save the Queen

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/51201979.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warnings:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings, Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Categories:
F/F, F/M, Gen

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Catra & Glimmer & Melog (She-Ra), Glimmer & Horde Prime (She-Ra), Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Horde Prime (She-Ra), Wrong Hordak (She-Ra), Horde Prime Clones (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Chipped Glimmer, Queen Glimmer (She-Ra), Glimmer is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Glimmer-centric (She-Ra), Glimmer Needs a Hug (She-Ra), Bow Needs a Hug (She-Ra), Everyone Needs A Hug, Horde Prime Being a Jerk (She-Ra), Warning: Horde Prime (She-Ra), Horde Prime's Ship (She-Ra), Traumatized Glimmer (She-Ra), Implied/Referenced Torture, Psychological Torture, Manipulation, The resistance also makes a short appearances!, Alternate Universe - Character Swap

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English

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Save the Queen

by Universe_Traveler

Summary

Catra tries to save Glimmer... But things don't go so well. Instead, Glimmer saves Catra from Horde Prime, knowing full well that Horde Prime needs her alive.

Now, the group returns to Horde Prime's ship...
To go save the Queen.

Currently Ongoing!!

Notes

I changed the tags, DO READ THEM IF YOU WISH TO CONTINUE!

Please note: Nothing will be too heavy, I aim to keep it as close as the show as possible, however, I saw missed opportunities that I want to exploit.
Rated Teen and up for swearing, and there will be future descriptions of violence and manipulation. (Mainly from Horde Prime, but well, what did you expect?)

Sorry to everyone who is subscribed to this fic, you're going to get another ping, but that's just me adding a secret SNEAK PEEK to the next chapter's summary, soooo...
My apologies!
(AND! You are all in for a TREAT! >:)!!)

- Inspired by [Restricted Work] by TippenFunkaport

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Chapter Summary

A table of contents!

:0

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Prologue: Corridors

Chapter Summary

In attempting to save the Queen goes a little wrong...

With Catra being sent out to space.

Chapter Notes

BECAUSE I DIDN'T LEARN MY LESSON YET...

ALLOW ME TO START ANOTHER SERIES!!

“Wha-?! Catra?" Glimmer exclaimed in shock as the doors hissed shut behind them.

"Get on the pad Sparkles!" Catra yelled, her tail twitching as she rushed to a nearby screen and started to rapidly type.

Glimmer's eyes widened as she noticed the words 'Teleportation pad room'. Catra was trying to get her off of Horde Prime, at the expense of her own life.

"No!" Glimmer yelled as the door banged loudly. "I won't let you stay behind. Horde Prime needs me *alive* . He doesn't need you alive."
Catra frowned. "This is to stop Adora! She's going to come here and get herself caught!"
Glimmer grit her teeth as the clones banged on the door. "Catra? I'm sorry, but if Adora- I lost you.. I wouldn't forgive myself. Adora cares deeply about you. I may be apart of the Heart, but you can convince Adora to not come. Horde Prime needs me alive to get the Heart of Etheria. He could kill you! Adora cares too much about you then to just leave you behind."

Catra growled. "Nice speach, but if I need to throw you, I will."

Glimmer shook her head. "No, Catra, I'm sorry."
She shot the gun at Catra as Catra shrieked in pain. Her limbs locked up and she was paralyzed. Glimmer then dragged the paralyzed cat over to the teleport pad, and rushed back to the screen.

Catra yelled from within the teleportation pad. "I'M SUPPOSED TO BE THE ONE SAVING YOU SPARKLES!"

She rapidly tapped somethings, having to get a feel for the screen. Then, she grinned as she was able to open communications.

"Adora!" Glimmer shouted, wincing as the sounds of the door being forced open behind her.

"Glimmer?!" Adora's voice was full of relief and joy.

"Yeah, hi! Uhm, I'm not alone here. I don't know where you are exactly, but I'm sending Catra to your coordinates. She's changed, she tried to send me to you. But she could die! Don't come here Adora, Horde Prime is waiting for you."
"Catra is with you?" Adora's voice was a mix of panic and surprise.

"Glimmer?" Glimmer heard Bow's voice distantly over the comm. Warm relief and joy at hearing his voice *alive* flooded her. Then, she felt the stabbing guilt that haunted her, and surprised that he even tried to come after her.

Then, the door was thrown open as clones flooded in, each grabbing and holding Glimmer back from the pad. "I'm serious, don't come after me! He wants *you* Adora! He needs me *alive* for the Heart. Take Catra and go back to Etheria, please!"

Glimmer yanked her arm out of one of the Clone's grasp and slammed it down on the screen, pushing upwards on a bar.

Catra was staring at Glimmer in horror and shock. (Glimmer also thought she saw some frustration in her gaze, but she wasn't sure.) Green particles surrounded the cat as she yelled out for

Glimmer. Then, she vanished in a plume of green smoke as Glimmer smiled to herself.

The cat was gone now.
She stopped fighting against the clones.
Hopefully they would heed her warnings.

Cats & Ships

Chapter Summary

Catra is teleported to Mara's ship where the rest of the gang greet her.
Things are tense, but Adora is just glad that Catra is alive.
Unspoken feelings are left to swirl.

Meanwhile, Glimmer is quickly finding out the consequences of staying behind...

Chapter Notes

Hii!

I hope you enjoy this chapter

Does contain some swearing! But nothing too much.
Oh and also, Adora is in love with Catra and is just an idiot about feelings.

Another warning, I may not be

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora stared at the communication line in shock, her eyes a wide, rounded mess. Nearby, Bow stared at the line in utter horror and fear. Panic was clear in his gaze.

"Hey Adora? Bow, if you're actually there… I wanted to say… I'm so sorr-" Then, the communication line was cut off abruptly, throwing Glimmer's voice into darkness. Panic spiked through the roof at Glimmer's voice cut off after sounds of her struggling.

"We need to get to Catra!" Adora yelled, trying to not think about what Horde Prime would do to Glimmer.

Adora rushed to grab her spacesuit, hurriedly shoving it on as Bow followed suit. The door of Mara's ship slipped open with a resounding hiss.

There! A form of glowing Green particles slowly grew in the resounding area of space. Leaving Catra gasping in the place. She stared at Adora as Adora started running and leaped towards Catra, her arms in front of her to get the cat. As she snatched Catra, Adora turned to see Bow starting to tug her back towards the ship in easy, short tugs. Adora relished in the way Catra's fur seemed softer than before, and her tail curled around her wrist.

As the bay door shut, Adora and Catra fell hard to the ground, Catra's eyes closed as Adora worried about her friend.

She was still wearing her Force Captain's outfit, all suited up and ready. Her hair was more of a mess and her fur was dirty and matted. As Catra collasped into Adora's grasp, she winced and groaned. Her movements jerky and slow as if she had been recently stunned.

"Catra?!" Adora asked, holding her friend closely.
Catra opened her mismatched eyes and stared into Adora's blue ones.

"Heyy Adora." Catra smiled at Adora,although her eyes portrayed a huge guilt. "I'm- I'm so.. sorry…"

"Catra, what happened?" Adora demanded quietly, worry about her friend leaking into her voice.
"Sparkles- Sparkles was convinced that if I had been the one to send her to you, I would've died. Probably has something to do with the whole 'Heart of Etheria' Sparkles had been talking about." Catra explained, barely moving.

"Glimmer is still on the ship?" Bow asked, and Catra startled as if she just realized Bow was there.

"I think we should discuss on the bridge." Adora suggested from where Catra leaned on her.

Catra struggled to stand, wincing weakly as her muscles didn't respond. It seemed as if she had been paralyzed.

"Catra? Are you okay?" Adora asked outloud, doing a scan over of her… Friend? Mortal Enemy? Acquaintance? Adora wasn't sure what they were, but strange feelings arose again.

Catra growled, one of the cute frustrated growls she let out sometimes. "I'm fine. Just… something Sparkles did."

That perked up both Bow and Adora.
"What did Glimmer do?" Bow asked from where he had been taking off his suit carefully.

"She somehow got her hands on one of the.. stun weapons Horde Prime- er, *they* had and hit me with it." Catra was able to move just a little, and by that she ducked her head close. The tips of her ears were tinged red for some unknown reason.

Feelings that Adora didn't understand swirled in her gut as Catra leaned into her unknowingly.

Once Catra had started to feel her muscles again, Adora helped her stand up. Catra tried to shove Adora away, as if Catra would burn Adora on contact, but Adora was persistent.

"Just. Leave me alone." Catra muttered after a minute of struggling between the two of them. "Leave me on the nearest habitable planet. I don't need help."
Adora shook her head. "I won't leave you behind. After we get Glimmer- if you want to still be abandoned, then we can drop you off. But please, I- I can't lose you…"

Catra's eyes widened in surprise at Adora's confession, Adora herself was actually surprised by it also.

She looked up to see Bow holding out his hand for Catra. "Catra, come with me. You need medical aid."
Catra blinked as Bow pointed at her shoulder, and Adora gasped in

surprise. There was a hole in Catra's clothing with a smothering spot on her shoulder. It looked like it hurt.

"Why do you want to help me?" Catra shot back, but it lacked the usual flare she usually spoke with.

"Because you're hurt and Adora cares about you." *You're also the only one who's been on Horde Prime's ship, the only one who's actually seen and knows what he's up to.* It was left unsaid, but Catra clearly picked that part up and her ears flicked back.

"Fine." Catra relented, letting Bow stand her up as Adora changed out of the spacesuit.

***

In the bridge, Adora paced along the same part of the floor as she pondered.

She was still worried about Catra, even though Catra insisted that she wasn't injured (Other than her shoulder), it still didn't leave Adora with a good feeling in her gut.

"Horde Prime needs Glimmer alive, so she sent you to us to both send us away and to save you?" Bow asked for what felt like the 15th time.

Catra simply nodded, making an affirmative noise as she stared into the abyss.

She had gotten the rest of her muscles in working order after Bow had worked on Catra's shoulder. She currently had been sitting on the floor, flinching from touch and loud noises.

"I'm going to kill Sparkles when we get her back." Catra mutter-growled out, her eyes slightly glazed over.
"Wait- you want us to go get Glimmer?"

“Well obviously not, but considering how close you and Arrow Boy are to Sparkles, I would assume you would go after her anyways. It’s part of the hero complex.” Catra’s tail flicked between Adora and Bow.

Meanwhile Entrapta was messing around with wires underneath the ship’s main computer as she mumbled to herself.

Catra still stared at Entrapta with a strange look filled with guilt. Catra opened her mouth before pausing, and then closing it resolutely shut.

Adora sighed, going back over her pacing area.

“Adora, sit down. You’re only going to get more nervous by endlessly pacing.” Bow pointed out as Adora gritted her teeth. She forced herself to sit down on the hard, metal floors of Mara’s ship.

Catra blinked in confusion, her gaze staring at a particular floor tile of the ship. She didn't say anything as Adora settled nearby.

“You’re just… Okay with me staying?” Catra asked in confusion as Adora settled down. Adora nodded. Knowing full well that she really, truly couldn’t express how much Catra truly meant to her.

Bow awkwardly scratched his neck. The gesture was clear. *Not yet, but soon.*

Adora nodded, smiling gently at her friend.

Catra shifted in her spot, her eyes moving back to stare at the very intresting floorboard again as she lapsed into silence.

“I’m sure Glimmer’s fine-” Adora started to say before Catra stiffened.

“No! She probably isn’t! She tried to make it sound as okay as possible to get you guys to leave! You- they-” Catra stuttered over

her words as she shivered recalling Horde Prime. “They- they do… I can't…”

Adora reached out to comfort Catra, but Catra flinched away from her touch as if it had burned. Adora tugged her hand back, but she still sent a worried glance over to Bow.

Bow stared at Catra with a horrified expression, turned to look at Adora with an expression of pain and horror in his gaze.

If Horde Prime scared someone like Catra this much… Adora shuddered. She didn't even want to know what he was doing to Glimmer.

Adora also knew that Bow and Glimmer were a lot more close then Adora was to either of them. Definitely some kind of… feelings there.

Catra stood up suddenly, turning around to flee the bridge. Adora stopped her though, gently holding her wrist. Catra flinched again at the touch before turning to stare at Adora, an expression of longing and pain in her gaze. Then, Catra jerks her arm out of Adora’s grasp and flees away.

Adora sighed, her hand coming to rest on her knee in thought. Suddenly, Entrapta speaks up for the first time since Catra had gotten on the ship. "Who's going to give her the tour of the ship?" Adora stiffened, turning to glance at Bow who had an expression of shock.

Oh no-

***

Glimmer was thrown into the jail cell with a resounding thud as she hit the wall. The clones threw her without a care, and Glimer

sat in her cell staring at the clones.

"Well well Princess." Horde Prime smirked from where he stood behind the stupid laser wall that seperated Glimmer and freedom.

She growled at Horde Prime.
"It's a pity you stayed behind and let our sister get away from us." Horde Prime mocked in an even tone. "I thought you hated her."

Glimmer growled out. "I- I do not hate her. I dislike her, yes, but she can change. Besides, Adora would come back for her anyways, and you would just kill her if I had escaped. That and you need me alive to activate the Heart."

Glimmer smirked at her small victory of words, as Horde Prime's expression turned sour for just a moment.

Horde Prime frowned. "Unfortunately yes, but I can assure you, your stay will be… a pleasure."
Glimmer bored her eyes into Horde Prime's eyes with a bored expression. "Worse than before?"
Horde Prime chuckled. "No no. A pleasure. You have a spark, something we can relate to."

I DON'T WANT ANYTHING TO DO WITH YOU . Her mind screamed as she bared her teeth like some kind of animal.

Horde Prime chuckled as if he was watching his favorite pet. "Oh, you're so cute."
Glimmer tensed at Horde Prime's words. Anger floods all of her emotions. 'I am not cute. Don't you fucking dare call me cute you-
'

He took a deep breath to steady her overflowing anger.

"You. Don't call me that." Glimmer forced out, barely containing the urge to snap Horde Prime's neck. (If she could, man that would be the day!)

Horde Prime chuckled again, no real warmth in his laugh. Cold, contained mechanical laugh that mocked Glimmer. "I wouldn't want to lose you again. You are too valuable to lose. Can't trade She-Ra for a dead Queen."

Glimmer grit her teeth.

If she had a coin for every time she was held hostage, she would be rich.

Glimmer growled at Horde Prime as Horde Prime crouched down to peer down at Glimmer from the other side of the screen.

"Well, *Queen* . I think you'll find out what happens when someone tries to escape from me **.** "

Glimmer swallowed hard at Horde Prime's expression of mild interest as if she was some kind of… test subject that he would experiment in just a few hours.

Her arms shook, but she grit her teeth to hide her fear. He wants to break her, she would never let that happen.

Please listen to me, please please leave. I'm sorry Adora, my dad I never met. I'm sorry Catra, Entrapta, Mermista, Frosta, Perfuma and everyone else in the alliance. Most of all… I'm so, so sorry Bow… I should've listened to you and Adora…

I- I should've told you after Princess Prom when I realized. We had so much time… I- I love you so much… It- I should've… Please Bow, please be safe.

Chapter End Notes

> On a scale of 1 - 10, how much should Glimmer swear? (1 = she should swear sometimes, as a treat. 10 = she should be able to swear every other sentence.) - I'm trying to keep this as gen-friendly as possible.
> (Also yes, Glimmer has been aware of her feelings since Princess Prom, a personal HC is that she's been aware of

them, but has been majorly suppressing them and been unable to comprehend them much until now when there is finally some time to think.)

Also! Do you have predictions for the future?
Because I certainly have a lack of planning laid out before me!
Chuckles nervously I'm in danger!

Also, PS: I added the Glimmer says sorry bc Catra had been already teleported when Glimmer said sorry and the Prologue was meant to kinda be (implied) Catra's POV? {I'm looking at you commenter who brought up some really good points.}

>:3 menacingly

New Haircuts and Mixed Feelings

Chapter Summary

Catra is now safe on the ship, however there are some very complex feelings around...

So, Catra does what she does best.
Impulsive actions!

Chapter Notes

Happy Reading!

((See End Notes for some Warnings as we continue onwards.))

:D

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra stared blankly at the ceiling above her in silence.

She couldn't sleep, every time she closed her eyes Horde Prime lurked just beyond her with a grin. Definitely not a nice grin, but one of evil.
Did I look like that? Catra wondered to herself as she stared at the ceiling. *Did I look like that when I watched buildings burn and tiny children rush out to look for their parents?*

She stood up abruptly, knowing full well that sleep would not come to her. She cracked the door open and glanced in the hallways. No sign of anyone, they were probably still in the bridge discussing anyways.

She creeped along the hallways, opening doors and peering into them in search of a bathroom.

It didn’t take until the 6th door that Catra finally opened the restroom. She walked to stare at her reflection. A reflection of a person who’d seen war, a shattered fractured shell of their former selves. She gently took the blade she had smuggled from Horde Prime, reaching it upwards. She paused then, unsure if she should continue, before she nodded.

Locks of matted, ragged hair collapsed around Catra’s feet. Her reflection showed a girl who lost everything. Now, all that was left was her hair.

Slash, slash.

A chunk gone from the left.

Hack, hack.

A chunk gone from the right.

Cut, shing.

The last of her hair fell to the ground.

Now, all she was left with was hair far too short for her liking. Hair that barely reached her neck halfway.

Her blade hit the floor with a small clang as Catra stared at her new reflection.

A girl who had finally lost it all.

Who had cracked and burned, fractured and spilled.

Now she was truly, and utterly broke.

Tears flowed down her face as she curled on the floor, her tail twitching closer around her body as she sobbed into the silent flight.

She heard the door creak open behind her, and she turned to meet the gaze of Entrapta.

“Oh! Hello Catra!” Entrapta said with fewer words than her usual vocabulary allowed her.

Catra scratched her neck nerviously. Everyone on this ship had to right reason to hate her. And yet..

“Why do you act so friendly to me? Even though… Even though I treated you so… Harshly?” Catra asked carefully, moving to tuck the sharp knife away from sight.

Entrapta tilted her head in thought.

Catra continued before Entrapta could speak. Endlessly apologizing to the purple-haired princess. Then, she felt something like hair on her shoulder.

Catra glanced up to see Entrapta looking at her with kind eyes.

“I forgave you Catra. Besides! I discovered all kinds of new technology at Beast Island.” Entrapta’s eyes sparkled as she painted an imaginary picture of Beast Island.

Catra winced slightly, her tail twitched away from her body. She stood up abruptly, muttering a goodnight to Entrapta before retreating back to the room that held all the beds. She curled in her bed, her tail curled tightly around her wrist. She stared at her wrist in anger.

She should’ve been the one left behind, not Sparkles. Distantly, Catra knew that Sparkles was strong, after all she survived Shadow Weaver. But, Horde Prime was a whole 'nother level.

“Dang it Sparkles, why did you take the fall I was supposed to? They wouldn't have hurt me anyways.” Catra growled out frustratedly.

Why did Sparkles have such a selfless attitude?

Catra recalled the moments on the ship between bars, where they would talk about nothing and everything. Nothing that hurt, Adora

and Arrow Boy. But past experiences, some funny, some sad.
It just made Catra realize how much they were both alike. Had Sparkles had grown up in the Horde, and Catra in BrightMoon, then they would have essentially swapped. They were both, truly, alone. Sparkles and Catra pushed everyone away, and now..

She bit back a sob that threatened to spill from her lips. Trying to curl around herself ever closer to rid of the darkness that surrounded her mind. Everyone should hate her, why do they care about if she was injured?

Adora especially, she… *cared* about Catra.

Why?

Catra grit her teeth, tears leaking out of the corner of her eyes.

She shouldn't be crying. Sparkles had a far worse experience than Catra had on that ship.
She shouldn't be crying, why was she crying?
Sparkles deserved more than remaining on that ship.

The door clicked open, bringing Catra back to her thoughts, she tried to even her breathing, but she wasn't sure how well she masked it.

Someone sucked in a deep breath, which was unfortunately very loud. Catra tried to screw her eyes shut.

I'm asleep, please leave… please…

Then, there was the sound of someone moving, and a weight on the bed.

"Oh Catra…" A voice, not just of someone, but of Adora. "I'm so sorry."

Why was she apologizing? Catra should be the one apologizing, over and over. Adora never did anything wrong.

Adora sighed, and she backed away from Catra, and Catra's heart panged with some… emotion.

Come back! It cried out pitifully, feelings that had long been buried tried to resurface, but Catra forced them back down forcibly. She couldn't, they were enemies. Adora should hate her, she had every right. She would never love a broken shell like her.

But then, the footsteps were back. And a warm weight settled over Catra.

Catra felt upset that Adora seemed to pretend to care. Why couldn't she do what Arrow Boy did and just not act like she cared. Arrow Boy didn't seem to care much about how Catra was feeling, although he was annoying with his looks in her direction. He clearly was upset with her, so why couldn't Adora do the same?

Catra's heart gripped tightly as Adora walked away again.
She fell into a fitful slumber instead.

Her dreams was nothing but peaceful. She was in an endless maze of narrow white corridors that pressed down into her. She was trapped by all angles, surrounded by those clones with narrowed green eyes.

She was running, Sparkles behind her as Sparkles was telling her something. Catra couldn't hear her words.

Then, Sparkles was falling, down deep into a pit. Catra reached towards her, towards a person who tried to understand her on that ship. Someone who Catra saw herself in, as Sparkles fell.

Then, Adora was falling, and Scorpia. Entrapta, and…
Then Catra was falling down that pit into endless darkness.

She hit the bottom, and was surrounded by glowing green eyes.

She tried to run, but a clawed grasp grabbed her and hauled her under again.

Chapter End Notes

Some warnings before we continue,

First: I have not watched She-Ra in a long time, so the majority of this fic is just going to be me improvising.

Second: I also have never actually experienced trauma of any kind, so a bunch of this may be incorrect on how the character would (canonically) react to trauma.
(That and Im using the internet which is notorious for (sometimes) spreading false facts.)

Third: I am Aro-Ace, so I have no experience with the feelings of romantic love, so I may be lacking in that department!

Finally: I would expect shorter chapters up until 'Lost in Space'. This is because I had already written 'Lost in Space before I realized that having some kind of middle-ground chapters would be best.

(FUN FACT! It was originally going to be a three-shot, with 'Lost in Space', 'Stranded' and 'Save the Queen'. I also had planned on doing a one-shot of a POV of the Rebellion back on Etheria as well, and I might still do that. I don't know, would you guys enjoy something like that?)

Bow's Nightmare

Chapter Summary

> Bow is angry at Glimmer, but most of all... He's worried about his friend.
>
> He has a nightmare and he finds a friend in an unusual force.

Chapter Notes

> Been a while. I'm more lamient on posting so then it's more... laid back kind of?
>
> I feel like I post more erratically, so I'm hoping that having a (semi-equal) time distance between each chapter will make it more smooth sailing.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Bow dreamed of BrightMoon.

Glimmer stood in front of their burning home, her hair blowing gently in the wind.

“Glimmer-” Bow stretched his hand towards her beautiful figure in a desperate attempt to bring her close.

Glimmer didn’t even turn to look back at Bow, she just wordlessly stared at the burning ruins.

“What have you done Bow?” She asked, anger lacing into her words.

Bow’s hand dropped and settled by his side as he wordlessly stared at Glimmer.

“Why did you let BrightMoon fall? Why did you let me be taken? This is all your fault.” Her words, they weren’t *hers* . They twisted

with an underlying evil that shifted and burned. Her burned and broken into pieces in the wind.

The ground shifted to cold white floors and an array of cells with green light that held the prisoners inside. Guards, each looking exactly like Hordak did stood between every cell with rapt attention. Inside the cell he stood at, Bow saw Glimmer curled on a hard cot. She was sobbing to herself quietly, her clothing was torn in places and blood stained the cot she lay in.

She endlessly apologized endlessly as she laid there. Wiping her face of tears as they kept pouring down.
Bow reached towards her in an attempt to soothe her pains. To hug her and tell her everything is alright.
His heart broke at the sight of his best friend hurting.

Glimmer didn't pay any attention, even as Bow was able to get to her side of the cell and put a comforting hand on her shoulder. She didn't even react to his touch as he desperately tried to get her to stop crying.

But then, Bow backed up a bit. He was still, rightfully, mad at Glimmer. Glimmer who didn't listen to her friends, but she didn't deserve this. He reached out towards her again, but stopped. Instead opting to settle next to Glimmer in silence.

Glimmer mumbled under her breath as Bow sat next to her in the cell. Bow turned to see his best friend slide off of the cot and stare at the wall blankly.

Distantly, Bow knew this was just a dream, but she looked so sad and *real* .
Then, the floor fell under Bow as Bow plunged into darkness.

He was at the Resistance.

Fires burned around him, leaving nothing but charred wasteland in its wake.
He heard the screams of his friends, his allies around him as they were thrown under Horde Prime's wraith.

Glimmer’s screams of pain and agony was the loudest in Bow’s ears. It shattered Bow’s soul at her screams.
He hated her screams.

Then, Bow jerked awake.

For the third time since they have taken off, Bow felt tired and restless at the same time. Running on pure adrenaline and fear and worry about his friends. That deep pain and swirling mix of emotions whenever he thinks about Glimmer.

He sat up, knowing full well that the bags under his eyes will only highlight the fact that he hasn’t slept even a tiny bit.

Bow sighed, staring across the room at the empty beds that sat at the other side of the room.

Adora was sleeping, and Catra’s bed was empty.
Bow wasn’t sure what to make of Catra recently, all things considered. She got the Queen killed, and yet tried to save Glimmer from Horde Prime. Bow wanted to hate her, she reminded him too much of Glimmer.. So, he really hasn’t talked to the cat much.

Adora was doing better though, seeing Catra alive seemed to have lifted a weight on one of her shoulders she wasn’t even aware of having.

Distantly, Bow wondered if Catra was okay from that ship. She seemed extremely shaken up by her visit on the ship.

Shaking his head, he stood up and slipped on a jacket that he had been able to scavenge from BrightMoon. It had been Glimmer’s but, well… He distantly hoped Glimmer wouldn’t mind if he wore it. It made him feel like she was just in the other room.

He breathed in deeply, shoving his nose into her jacket.

He stood up and left the room, and he wondered if he should find Entrapta and help with the ship or take over driving.

As he entered the bridge, his eyes widened in surprise to see Catra sitting on the floor of the bridge staring at her crown-y thing she always wore from The Horde. Catra hasn't seen him yet. He noticed that her hair was shorter than usual, and it was cut jaggedly.

Bow wordlessly walked past Catra, hearing Catra let out a small hiss of surprise.

Bow stood by where Entrapta steered the ship, and he gently put a hand on the concentrating princess. She hopped in surprise, causing the ship to do a little hop in space.

"I can take over driving." Bow said once Entrapta had gotten the ship steady.

Entrapta nodded, eagerly hopping off as Bow settled on the steering wheel.

"Sleep Entrapta! I don't think I've seen you sleep for more than 1 hour at a time." Bow scolded the purple haired princess.

Entrapta waved him off as she started to go towards the prow of the ship.

"Entrapta…" Bow warned the girl who crouched down.

"Master Entrapta, please sleep. I will wake you in… 4 hours." Darla's voice spoke as the glowy sphere floated above the table.

Entrapta stared at Darla. "Why are you teaming up with him?"

"You need sleep. I will wake you up in… 4 hours." Darla responded with the same even tone.

Entrapta sighed. "Okay, but I will be back in 4 hours!"
Bow chuckled as the technology princess retreated away, and

turned to Darla.

“Change the wake up time to 8 hours.” Bow commanded.

“Already on that.” Darla responded far too quickly.

Bow chuckled again as he started to steer the ship carefully.

There was a moment of silence, which let Bow decipher his feelings in silence.

He didn’t want Glimmer to suffer, but he was still mad with her choices. His heart hurt at the thought of Glimmer in pain. He grit his teeth quietly. He wasn’t sure what could happen when they meet up with Glimmer again.

He stared ahead as he mulled about Glimmer and all the complex emotions associated with her. Watching the stars fly past as the ship zooms through space.

“How does that even work?” A voice startled Bow.

Bow dropped the steering wheel, letting out of his childish screams, and the ship came to a slow stop as Bow’s heart beat wildly. He turned to see Catra looking startled and… scared?

She looked like a lost puppy in the rain.
“Oh my gosh. Catra! You scared me!” Bow breathed out deeply, before turning Catra’s question through his head.

“Oh! Well, it’s some very complex First One’s tech… Entrapta could probably explain it better than I could-”
Catra held up her hand. “Oh no no. Entrapta will start speaking another whole language. Just give me how it works and I’m good.”

“Oh, well, you drive using this!” Bow brought up the screen he had been using previously. “Although, you can change it to become any shape you want. I usually just prefer it like this.” Bow gestured to the screen.

Catra stared at the screen hard. “Erm, okay then.”
Bow chuckled as Catra ‘s footsteps receded again.

There was a comfortable silence again as Bow steered through space. Then, Bow hummed in thought.

“Hey Catra? When did you cut your hair? It looks nice.” Bow smiled to himself.

“Huh? Oh, uhm.. yesterday night. I suppose having my hair back kind of hid it…” Catra mumbled, sitting nearby the chair. She absentmindedly ran her fingers through her short locks.

Catra’s tail tucked close to her side as she stared at Bow. She tilted her head as if she was in front of an extremely complex math problem that has eluded her until now.

“You confuse me, Arrow Boy. You always have. Where are you in your… group? Adora is the leader, Sparkles is the… impulsive one and also a leader, and you… are the ranged fighter?” Catra asked quietly, almost daring Bow to answer.

Bow didn’t have anything else to do, so he answered her. “Uhm, yeah. That and I sometimes come up with plans. usually I’m the one with the sensible brain.”

“Why do you hang out with them, even though Sparkles and Adora are so different from you?” Catra wondered again, fiddling with her crown-y piece as she waited.

“They’re my friends!” Bow smiled, keeping his eyes trained forwards determinedly.

Catra made a humming noise as she fell silent. It was after a moment when she spoke up again.

“Why are you not mad at me?”
“Hm?” Bow blinked in surprise at that question, noting no other help needed and set the ship to autopilot. He turned to Catra and met her mismatched gaze.

“Why do you act like you’re not… mad at me? You’re- You’re the only one of the group who knows me the least.” Catra shifted awkwardly.

“I am, I just… I trust Glimmer, and she said you’re okay. I trust Adora, and you two are still friends. I just…” Bow sighed. “Friendship problems. This is me giving you your second chance.”

Catra mumbled quietly to herself. Then, she sneezed.

And WOW was it the CUTEST SNEEZE EVER! Bow’s eyes were practically sparkling at her tiny cute sneeze.

“Awwww! That’s your sneeze?”
Catra’s tail fluffed up which only made Bow coo again.
“Yeah? What about it?”
“It’s just so… so… CUTE!”
Catra stiffened, tucking her arms close together to appear defensive. “I am not cute.”
Bow chuckled. “You so are.”

Catra grumbled to herself. “I cannot believe we were losing to you guys.”

Bow chuckled again.

For the first time since they took off, he truly felt free.

Chapter End Notes

> I really don't know how to portray love...
> honestly I just kinda dragged my friend to get some love-kinda sounding words.
>
> So, if it kind of sounds disjointed, that would be my friend helping me!

Butting heads

Chapter Summary

Glimmer reflects and learns the consequences of refusing Horde Prime

Meanwhile the Rebellion is going to learn something terrible…

Chapter Notes

WARNING:
Pain, Horde Prime being a jerk and kinda depression-like themes?

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Glimmer had no friends on the cold hallways of her prison.

The only thing that brought her comfort was the thought of her friends, particularly Bow, alive and fighting back. Her father, leading the resistance with all he has…
There were no visitors, only immense loneliness.

That's what Horde Prime wants. For Glimmer to break.

How long had she been there sitting in that small cell staring at nothing?

Not for the first time, Glimmer entertained the idea of her friends coming to rescue her, but just like every other time, she shook her head resolutely. Her friends couldn't come, bad things would happen if they did. No matter how much her heart screamed in agony.

Didn't she deserve this? She ignored her close friends to follow her own impulsive actions. Actions which lead to this moment. Actions which she would undoubtedly will have (and already had) faced the consequences for.

Did they hate her? Probably. It was deserved, she was an absolutely horrible friend.

Being alone gave Glimmer a lot of free time to just… Think. Think from new perspectives, Catra, Bow, Adora. Think with a different mind, one that has seen the horrors of their own consequences, and has yet to see the hatred of their friends.

But every new perspective Glimmer analyzed, she always came back to one single thing.

Bow.

That fluttery feeling that hovered over Glimmer's heart in every memory. Something which she just never analyzed since Princess Prom. Feelings that just had to be buried even deeper, no matter how much it hurt. Love. More than just platonic love, and the Princess Prom proved that to her. It made her scared at how much Bow meant to her.

Catra, now that was an interesting perspective to look through. They were so similar it made Glimmer's head hurt. Maybe in another life, Catra had been the impulsive Queen of BrightMoon and Glimmer was the Force Captain of the Horde. Catra pushed onwards through experience and stress, Glimmer pushed onwards through determination and desperation.

Both had been herded by Shadow Weaver, thrown off balance and tumbling to the great unknown.

Glimmer wanted to feel angry at Catra, and she did, but… What she saw instead was just… herself. She thought about how her friends would feel if the roles had been reversed.

Would they hate her for flipping that switch, even give her a second chance?
Was it even a good idea to send Catra to her friends? Would they react negatively or positively?
Not for the first time, Glimmer wished she had said more in her

call. Only for that moment, she heard Adora's and Bow's voices, she wished she had followed the urge to talk more.

If only she had known more about how the technology worked, then she could've talked while she did everything right. Once again, Glimmer wondered what would've happened if Catra and her had switched places.
She felt a stabbing of homesickness as she shuffled a little.

"Esteemed Majesty, I have brought you food." One of the clones spoke, sliding a tray to Glimmer from the otherside.

Glimmer stared at the food, unsurprised to see less than yesterday.

Horde Prime did that sometimes. He would give Glimmer so much food every so often (every hour?), other times he only gave Glimmer the barest amount that someone could live off of. The unpredictability drove Glimmer insane. She hated not knowing if she would get so much food next or if her next meal would be in two days.

(Well, she could only assume it was days. Very hard to tell in a room with no windows in the middle of space.)

She glared at the food like it had personally offended her. It actually probably did. Unfortunately, the food just sat there innocently.

The clone who had given her food had vanished just as quickly as he had appeared. Glimmer growled angrily. Again, not for the first time, Glimmer considered refusing to eat.
But, nonetheless, Glimmer swallowed the disgustingly bland, tasteless food. She winced at how slimy it was, but did not complain.

It was mostly done before Glimmer shoved it away. She would not eat more. Instead, she returned to where she lay on the floor staring at the ceiling with glazed eyes.

It was days like this where she… missing Catra. Even though Catra would sometimes come at random times to sleep at Glimmer's feet. Glimmer felt a pang as she stared at a lone tuff of fur that settled at the foot of the bed. The only company in the lonely cell.

(Glimmer was certain that Catra sleeping was what she did with Adora, if so, then Adora's first night makes a whole lot of sense now. But now, now Glimmer can't help but wonder how hard it was for Catra to sleep if she had slept with Adora like this all her life. Did she do it to Scorpia? Glimmer shook her head to dispeal those thoughts. They wouldn't help her here.)

She reached over and took the clump of fur, and gently set it where Catra constantly settled down, wordlessly covering it with her too thin blankets to hide it.

(Why? Glimmer wasn't sure. It wasn't embarrassing, but well… Maybe it was because it was helping Glimmer survive this… nightmare. Maybe it was a tiny bit embarssing, but she didn't want to lose it strangely enough.)

She sighed, moving to settle again and stare blankly, now her gaze on that ball of fluff.

***

Horde Prime came one day, a smirk that Glimmer so badly wanted to wipe off his face with a good punch to the face.

"Well hello, Queen. How are you enjoying your extended stay?" Horde Prime cackled, his teeth forming into an unfriendly grin.

Glimmer grit her teeth, staring unresponsive at the wall before her.

She refused to answer Horde Prime's question.

Horde Prime hummed.
"You've been very… particular, in not cooperating." Horde Prime mused through the other side of the wall. "I suspect that if you keep this up, I will have to turn to more… *dramatic* measures."

Glimmer clenched her fists tightly, still unanswering Horde Prime's musings.

More dramatic measures? Glimmer wondered to herself. She resisted the urge to ask what kind of measures, as that would only make Horde Prime more smug. She distantly wondered if it would be worse than what she suffered in the Horde so long ago by Shadow Weaver's hands.

Horde Prime scoffed at Glimmer's lack of response.
"You two, bring her along to the room." Horde Prime gestured to the two clones that stood outside her cell.

The door opened and Glimmer was dragged up by harsh grips. Glimmer yelped in surprise as the two clones hauled her up as she came face-to-face with Horde Prime.

Glimmer growled. Oh how much she wanted to punch him.
"You have a very punchable face." Glimmer growled, ignoring that she should be polite. But well, Horde Prime needed her alive so she could practically do whatever she could to annoy him.

Horde Prime simply raised his eyebrow. Then, he chuckled. "Oh, I've missed having such a fiery spark like you. The last one lost their flare before I could even do anything. I've missed how fun it is to hold such a flame in my ship."
Glimmer's rage only spiked at his words. She wasn't some kind of *prize* ! She wasn't an object that people could own. She was her own person, she was Queen Glimmer of BrightMoon. Not a *toy* for some fucking jerk.

"Fuck you." Glimmer growled angrily, spitting in Horde Prime's face.

Horde Prime simply smirked, one of his unfriendly smirks. He didn't say anything back, and simply turned around as the two clones dragged Glimmer behind them.

Glimmer didn't fight it. They had weapons and she didn't. Besides, it wasn't like her friends were coming anyways, so even getting off the ship would be near impossible, and getting home even more impossible.

Glimmer gasped at the unfamiliar room that she was dragged into. It was tall and from the bottom to top was covered in glittering white panels. Glimmer shrank against the green-eyed stares of the clones that closed in around her. The floor was slick and clean, and in the center of the room it dropped off.

The two clones threw Glimmer into the hallowed circle in the center of the room, and she splashed into the green liquid that was settled there. It burned her skin, sending waves of pain through her body as her muscles felt like they were failing. Her legs shook with effort to stand up, and her arms wobbled as she tried to hold her head above the liquid.

"What the- What is this?!" Glimmer shouted at Horde Prime, baring her teeth angrily.

"This is the alternative solution, *Queen* . If you continue to refuse to cooperate, we will simply force you too." Horde Prime spoke, bringing Glimmer's attention to him. He sat on a throne in front of her, and it was at just an angle that it hurt to crane her neck to see him. He stared down at Glimmer with an indifferent expression on his face.

Glimmer grit her teeth. "You need me *alive* -"
"Oh I know we need you alive. You won't die, you'll just simply be… more agreeable." Horde Prime interrupted Glimmer.

Glimmer growled. "How is this going to work? What does that even fucking mean?!"

Horde Prime smiled, his mouth curling upwards like a predator who's prey was right where it wanted it. "Well, I'm sure you will see… unless you want to tell me how to activate the Heart of Etheria. Everything you know about the resistance and… *She-Ra* ."

Glimmer growled. "I will not. I don't even know anything about the new resistance. As for the Heart of Etheria, I'll never tell you."

Horde Prime chuckled. "Very well then."
He waved two clones over, and their clawed hands reached out towards her.

Right then, Glimmer swore that punching Horde Prime would be at the very top of her list. Right below destroying Light Hope and above throwing Adora and Catra into a closet if those two ever sorted things out between them and locking them in there until they work out that horrible sexual tension.

Very, very high on her list of very important things to do if she ever got out of here alive.

Then, they shoved her under.

Sharp, excruciating pain stabbed her as the liquid swarmed her.

She was pretty sure she was yelling. Screaming? All she could see was those empty green eyes of Horde Prime staring down at her with a self satisfied smirk.

Oh wait, she was screaming. She was screaming in pain. Probably explained why she couldn't feel anything except pain.

And then inky, green, calm darkness overwhelmed her as she succumbed to the darkness.

Mermista quietly read a book as chaos ensued around her.

She heard footsteps next to her and turned as Perfuma settled down nearby.

"They're still arguing?" Perfuma wondered as she stared at the bickering group.

"Unfortunately." Mermista droned. "Have been for like, ever." Perfuma nervously tapped her fingers on the stone floor. "I don't like arguments like this. Everyone at each other's throat…" *It's honestly the most boring part.* Mermista grumpily thought. *But I least I can get away from everyone.* "Eh, they'll quiet down or whatever later." Mermista flipped to the next page in her book.

The duo was pushed into silence again, the only sounds between them was Mermista occasionally flipping to the next page in her book.

Then, Perfuma sighed. "I hope everyone else is okay."

Mermista sighed as she flipped another page.

No one noticed the chips that clung to the princesses.

No one would notice, not until it was far too late.

Chapter End Notes

> Been a while huh? This is the only Glimmer-centric chapter and I really do not know if I did her justice.
> Honestly, I don't exactly know how love works minus reading fics, sooo… woo.
>
> Also Catra and Glimmer, the've got such a good dynamic I love it.

Lost in Space

Chapter Summary

Darla has some... mishaps.

Bow finds a new, unlikely (and possibly trusting?) ally as he reminiscences the past. (She's stuck in his head and he can't get her out.)

Meanwhile, Catra considers her situation and is terrible at comforting people. (She wishes she had just taken her hand so long ago...)

Chapter Notes

I feel like there should've been a tad more between the rescuing Glimmer and 'Stranded', so I added a mini-adventure which can only bring everyone closer!

... right?

Hmm... man, I could do for some good ol' water right about now...

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Bow stared at the abyss of space.

It was silent as the stars passed by. Only puncuated by Entrapta's declaration.

"I'm afraid to inform you, that we are officially very, very lost." Entrapta spoke up,

Bow winced as he glanced over to where Adora and Catra kind of hung out.

Adora frowned worriedly at Entrapta. “What do you mean… ‘lost’?”

“Well, we’re currently in the middle of space surrounded by mostly gas giants, oh and also not to mention our engine is only running at 40% power because we are lacking in hyper-space dimensional travel crystals to fill up our fuel-” Entrapta rapidly explained before Catra interrupted her.

“In english please?” Catra asked.

“Basically, we’re trapped and low on fuel which makes ship go.” Bow butted in from where he stood at the console. “If we want to go rescue.. Glimmer, we need more fuel. However, where we are right now we are in no place for finding fuel. We’re surrounded by planets made out of entirely gas. Meaning we can’t land on them.”

“THANK YOU! Seriously, where were you Arrow Boy when we needed you!?” Catra exclaimed as Bow chuckled.

It was a nice break from the chaotic stressfulness that had he had been being put through before Catra being rescued. Bow shuddered at the tape mess and Entrapta’s outdoor trip.

“Soo, what are we going to do?” Adora spoke up, her voice tinged with nervousness.
“Well, we need to map the area, best way is to leave Darla still and use as minimum amount of energy as possible.” Bow explained before Entrapta had the chance to use her expanded vocabulary.

Bow tapped some buttons animatedly as the ship slowed to a halt. Many of the additional reserves turned off to save power. He heard Adora and Catra shuffling awkwardly behind him as Darla’s voice came on.

“Turning off all additional reserves that are unnecessary.” Darla’s voice cooed.

“Unnecessary reserves? Like what?” Adora asked.

“Air, water, comfort and heat comes to mind.” Darla responded and Bow’s heart rate increased 10 fold.

“WHAT?! Air and heat are ESSENTIAL FOR US SURVIVING SPACE!” Bow exclaimed loudly. He whipped to Entrapta.
“Entrapta?”
“It seems that the authentication and the main operating system has shortwired and is now backlashing into a massive amount of friction. If left unchecked then the tensile strength of the console and the very ship itself tear it’s engine apart and fulmate!” Entrapta said in an awefully cheerful voice.

“Uhm- Translation?”
“Id and main files don’t like each other. So it’s backlashing a large amount of pressure which could cause the ship to go boom.” Bow said in an uninterested tone as if this was normal occurance.
“How long do you think?”
“Ohh, might take a day, might take a few hours? Depends on if Darla will work with me here!” Entrapta chuckled as she plunged into the hull.

Bow sighed. “I’ll try to keep Darla from turning off air, I probably can’t do two, so air would have to be better.”
Bow turned to Adora and Catra. “I hope you’re in for a cold ride.”

***

Catra hated the cold. It was even worse than the cold skin of the clones on Horde Prime’s ship. She tucked the jacket that had been thrown at her closer around her body in silence.
She had tucked her thin blanket as Arrow Boy and Entrapta

struggled against Darla for what felt like hours. Sometime during which Adora had fallen asleep curled up next to Catra.

It was strange how easy it was to draw Adora closer. To tuck her blanket over her shoulders and share body warmth.
It made Catra sick, and also… happy? It was a strange mix of feelings.

She wanted to shove Adora away, but at the same time wanted to hug her ever closer to share warmth.

She watched as Bow fought with an all-powerful AI in charge of literally their lives. Entrapta was rapidly screwing something frantically as Adora snored peacefully next to Catra.

Catra grumbled, no real anger in her voice as all she could do was sit around and wait. She stared blankly at all the flashing lights with no real interest in her gaze. She stared blankly at the flashing lights.

Bow glanced backwards towards Catra. His face panicked as he glanced back towards Catra.

"Catra? Could you help with something? I mean, you don't have to, but you're probably the most flexible-" Bow stammered, as Catra stood up quickly.

"Uhm, yeah. What do you need?" Catra shuffled up, tucking the blanket closer around Adora as she walked over to Bow. She shivered as the bitter cold pressed against her skin.

"Well, we need someone to get out of the ship and go to an outer panel." Bow explained, bringing up a big image of the ship. He turned it and a big red dot appeared on the top of the ship. "It was destroyed, and we need someone to put this drive into the blue plug."

Catra frowned. "You want me, to handle technology?"
Bow shrugged. "Adora is currently asleep and we're kinda in a meteor field. So unless you want to wake up Adora, you're

probably the best person. That, and Adora has been barely sleeping.” Bow added, muttering quietly under his breath.

Catra glanced back towards Adora who mumbled something in her sleep.

{Bow noticed Catra’s eyes softened when they landed on Adora. Definitely some more-than-just-friends-/-enemies feelings there.}

“Yeah, I can do it. So the blue plug?” Catra turned back to Bow.
Bow nodded. “There is only one blue plug out there. At least, there should only be one.. If there is multiple, go with the lightest colored blue. Like the sky.”
“The sky isn’t blue. It’s purple..” Catra blinked in confusion, then, her brain kickstarted. “OH you mean the rest of the world’s sky- yeah okay. Sure.”

She snatched the drive and started to make her way to the hull before pausing. “Wait- I don’t know how to wear those heavy suits that you and Adora wore…”
“Oh that’s simple, just click in the holding line in tight form. Then, settle the suit on, make sure it’s tight! Then, take a leap of faith!” Entrapta chuckled from where she working on the front panel.

“Erm… Okay?” Catra’s ears flicked back, running to the hull.

She quickly put on the suit and made sure that the line thing was tight. Tight enough to draw her back if she gave into it’s pull. Then, she shoved on the helmet.
She grumbled at how uncomfortable it was. Her ears were bent at odd angles and she growled angrily as she shruggled. Eventually, she landed on having her ears pinning forwards, unfortuntely that made it hard to hear anything.

Then, she pressed some buttons. She wasn’t sure what opened the hull, so she pressed the most likely ones. When they didn’t work, Catra just started pressing random numbers.

Eventually, it worked and the hull opened, but the screen also was flashing red. Which honestly didn't seem like a good sign, but Catra shrugged. It could be dealt with later.
She paused before jumping, feeling the cold of space bite at her suit. Uncomfortably, she shuffled, holding the drive close as she took the leap of faith.

She floated in space. For a quick, panicky moment Catra thought that she was in the portal, and that none of this ever truly happened. She wondered if where she was now was like space. Where you floated indefinitely until you can't anymore.

What if this was just a dream? What if everything went back to Catra & The Horde vs the world. She and Sparkles never formed a semi-balance between them. Back when Adora could act like she never existed. Back when Catra still was confused by Arrow Boy's place in the group.

Catra wanted to wake up, but another part of her wanted to… stay. Not wake up and see this was all fake all along.

Maybe, maybe it was her finding out that there was someone out there who understood her. Much less it be Sparkles of anyone. Maybe it was Adora acting… caring of Catra now?

She was pretty sure that Arrow Boy didn't factor in… But, maybe how he is.. nice to her counts as something?
She didn't know.

Then, she was hit by a meteor and snapped back to reality as she grabbed the outside of the ship.

She rubbed her hand (glove?) over her chest where the meteor hit her. Then, she gripped the drive closer as she started clawing her way up.

It was difficult to do with only one hand available… but Catra managed. The ship was slippery and Catra more often than not almost went flying into the vastness of space.

Thankfully, she was able to get a solid grip as a meteor came hurling at her. Instinctively, Catra ducked, watching as the comet soared overhead.

She winced as the comet crashed into another hunk of floating debris causing the second rock to be shattered upon impact.

She really didn't want to be on the receiving end of *that* . She shuddered at the thought.

Momentary she forgot what she had come out into space to do once she had successfully clambered onto the top of the ship. It wasn't until she saw a sparking panel did she recall.

Where was the drive?! She frantically dug around in search of the saving grace. She had lost it.

She felt the spike of her self-loathing shoot up, ready to drag her back down into the depths. She shook herself, she couldn't get lost now. Her… friends rescuers needed her!

She whirled around, her eyes keenly scanning the area desperately. She didn't notice that her hand loosened and the drive floated right past her until it was slightly too late.
Catra lunged towards the drive in desperation, reaching for it's glittering metal. It brushed against her fingers…

It was drawn back into Catra's grasp and she breathed a sigh of relief. Bringing the drive to hold close as she sighed.

Turning to the panel, she pryed it open and scanned the different ports. Finally, she found the blue port.

Sticking the drive into it, she clicked, tapping the side of her helmet to signal she did it.

(Unfortunately the space suits was only a one way communication. She could signal, but unless she knew this… 'morse code' that Entrapta talked so much about, she couldn't actually talk back.)

“Okay, okay, that’s good, thanks Catra.” Arrow boy’s voice murmered over the comm and Catra involuntarily shivered. “Take out the drive and come back, the system is back on.”

Catra smiled, gently tugging the drive out and shutting the trapdoor rather forcefully. She didn’t mind, or notice really. She wanted to stand on something solid and not in the strange gravity of the abyss of space.

She shuddered. It was worse than being in water, where she was endlessly floating in the coldness of space. (Distantly Catra wondered what would happen if she had just let herself get swept into space. Would anyone miss her? Would *Adora* miss her? *Scorpia* ?)
She shook her head, she couldn’t- no shouldn’t think about that now. She had to at least try to help… them… and her.

Catra shook her head, trying desperately to disperse the sight of the sad, lonely pink haired princess that sat in her lone prison cell.

She couldn’t think of that now. (Why was she so willing to help? She saw another flash of pink. The princess who reminded her so much of herself.)

She couldn’t think of that, the quicker she goes into the ship, the better.

She shimmied her way down, silently hating the gloves she was forced to wear as she could feel her claws slide out.

She hated it.

Soon, but not as soon as Catra had wanted, she had arrived back in the bay. She slid out of the bulky suit and clutched the drive close in her hands, hating at how it’s bitter cold seeped into her fur.

She entered the cockpit to see an usual sight. Was Arrow Bow… crying?

Catra blinked as she stared at the sight. Adora was loudly snoring, Entrapta was (predictably) by the computer fiddling with something, and Arrow Boy was crying on the floor, his legs tucked up to his chest as he stared at the computer.

"Erm, do I want to know?" Catra neriously stared at the sight, her ears twitching.

"Nah, probably not." Entrapta spoke without looking up. "He's been like that for a whil, after you put the drive in. Something abut sparkles…?"

Catra tilted her head. "Sparkles? Like… Princess Sparkles?

Entrapta shrugs halfheartedly.

Catra winced. How were you supposed to act when someone was… leaking water from their eyes?? Sure, Scorpia cried, but like never actually looked like… that. Unfiltered pain and sadness leaked through his face and down his neck.

"Erm…" Catra glanced at Adora, very temped to wake her up, but considering how little Adora's been sleeping, she dispeased the thought. Instead she started to turn to Entrapta, who might actually know what to do, but pausing recalling how Entrapa doesn't exactly care about humans as much as she does robots.

Catra inwardly groaned. She was going to have to confort him isn't she? Ugh.

She took a step forward, and then another, and quietly settled next to Arrow Boy. "Okay so uhm. I suck at these… 'emotions' crap, so I'm going to say something that might make you feel better or worse." Catra started, clearing her throat to alert Arrow Boy of her presence.

She felt Arrow Boy shift next to her to peer up at her with curious eyes.

Catra swallowed, her throat suddenly dry and scratchy. She fumbled for the right words, unknowing if she would be able to confront his feelings or not. She considered backing off, but well, she already came this far… "Erm…" Why was the words failing her?!

Arrow Boy stared at her as she fumbled around.
"So uhm… I somewhat respect you. Erm, Bow, you'll be okay. You know… Ah, at the… ship." Catra winced at what she was going to say. (Why was she saying this??) That did not come out as she intended. "Erm…"

"She… She feels guilty for bringing Horde Prime to Etheria…" Catra winced. "She loves you, were you aware of that?"

Catra didn't look up to see Arrow Boy's expression, but she could feel the intensity of his gaze.

"Ah, I'm not good at this… Sparkles often told me I was terrible at comforting… I guess another thing in common with her." Catra shifted. Oh how badly she wanted to run, but she had to finish. (Why? What was urging her forwards??)

There was a tense silence between the duo, broken by Arrow Boy finally, *finally* speaking.

"You don't have to tell me." His voice was… soft and ew, kind. It made Catra want to squirm but also… She kind of… enjoyed it? It was strange, was this how you were supposed to comfort people??

Catra shook her head. "No, you need to know, at least a little. She, she often talked about you, w… when she was…" *okay with talking about you.* went unsaid. Arrow Boy and Adora was often topics the duo wouldn't talk about on bad days, but sometimes in the dead of night they would whisper about the two unspeakable topics. "She missed you and…" *She loves you.* "She wanted to make things right."

(That look Sparkles had given Catra when she had sent Catra off into the unknown of space. Desperation and pain and sadness, a quiet look of understanding and almost… acceptance of never fitting in again. Of being hated by her friends as she whispered her deepest darkest fears.)

"She knew that you, both of you, maybe even all of you, would hate her. She was…" *willing* "okay with that." Catra probably wasn't helping, not at all. (Why did Arrow Boy not hate her? Why did he trust her so much?) "She… sent me to *protect me* ." (Why did she want to protect Catra, her captor, her rival, the person who watched her suffer at Shadow Weaver's hands?)

Catra shook her head. "Ah, I'm sorry, I'm… I'm probably not helping huh? I… er.. I'm terribly sorry about that. Uhm…" Catra struggled upwards to stand, drawing in on herself to appear smaller and to hide from Arrow Boy's far too bright eyes.

Catra went to pat on Arrow Boy's back, it was awkward and she stumbled upwards. "Things will get better soon?" Catra didn't mean to phrase it as a question. Still, she could feel Arrow Boy's gaze on her as she stumbled.

She felt like stabbing her brian out and wiping herself from that awkward conversation. She could feel his gaze, but right know she really did not want to face it. She decided at that moment, she would ignore Arrow Boy's presence for at least a week. She shuddered involuntarily.

Never again. Catra silently promised. *Never again will I be comforting someone, ever.*

She settled an arm's length away from Adora, turning away from Arrow Boy as she could still *feel* his gaze on her. She really wanted him to stop *staring at her* . It really made her want to squirm and shift uncomfortably.

She was distracted by Adora shifting and throwing an arm over her shoulders, hugging her tightly as Adora scooched closer to

Catra. Instinctively, Catra tried to shove Adora away, unused to human contact, her tail fluffed up. However, Adora refused to budge, and instead, snuggled closer to Catra. Catra grumbled as Adora kept a firm hold on her before finally giving in and wordlessly staring off into space.

She was falling asleep, and she desperately tried to claw to the surface. She couldn't fall asleep, not now! But unfortunately, her body didn't follow her desperations.

Just as sleep encompassed her, she heard Entrapta say something and Arrow Boy responded back. She couldn't hear the words, but she did hear 'power'.

"Why did Arrow Boy trust her?"

Then, she fell into a peaceful slumber.

***

Bow stared at a slumbering Catra.

He blinked as he heard her mumble something, and turned around his eyes wide.

Why do I trust her?

He blinked, humming to himself.

Bow knew the answer, but he was scared of it.

He rubbed his eyes, desperately trying to get rid of the tears. Catra was as bad at comforting people as Glimmer was. The similarities was uncanny.

(Bow chest hurt about thinking of Glimmer. The new information from Catra only made him sadder, his chest ached with a familiar

feeling.)

He smiled sadly, moving to pick up Adora and Catra gently. Thankfully, all the heavy lifting of his bow on the battlefield was quite useful now. That and it probably didn't help how thin and light Catra was, so mainly Bow had to carry Adora. He gently tucked the two into a bed, gently covering them up before turning away.

(He longed for that, but… He had his own problems he had to deal with….)
Bow shook his head. He shouldn't- couldn't think about… (Her, he couldn't, no matter still he kept coming back to see her in his mind.)

Bow took a deep breath, and closed the door behind him as he stepped away from the sleeping corridors.

Chapter End Notes

> And they were ALL OBVIOUS to Glimmer's prediction... (~muhahaha~)
>
> Ahem.
> Thoughts?
> Man, writing Catra struggling at comforting was a challenge. Because I'm pretty good at comforting lol. I actually had to get my friend to help me with Catra's dialogue...
> [Wait... would that technically mean that they are a beta reader even tho I don't have any beta readers...? Hmmmm....]

NEXT CHAPTER SNEAK PEEK:

The resistance launches an operation, and Swift Wind and Scorpia talk.
Meanwhile on a distant planet the new BFF (- Glimmer, + Entrapta) squad faces new challenges on a distant planet in

search of a power source.
Adora realizes that maybe Catra truly has changed for the better.
(Glimmer has moments in between where everything is clear, but not long enough.)

Stranded

Chapter Summary

The group is forced to land on a desolate planet... with no life (?) to look for crystals to continue their mission.

Catra and Bow have more heart to hearts, and Adora feels slightly jealous. (For no reason at all.)
The mission continues.

Chapter Notes

Hiii!! Been a while huh?

Man, this month's been rough, but second fic that is getting another chapter! Woohoo!

(Hope it's worth the wait!)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora jerked awake to a blaring siren.

She had her nose buried in some sort of fluffy blanket that was warm and soft. Then she realized her pillow was *breathing* .

Adora forcefully bit her tongue to not startle the other person as she pulled back to stare at her makeshift pillow.

Catra. Catra was settled below her, curled and quietly breathing. Adora's face burned, and she shuffled away from Catra wordlessly.

(How was Catra sleeping so soundly while that siren is going?? Adora could only wonder.)

She ignored the bubbling feelings that swirled in her stomach. Anger, and… something else. She had decided to just ignore them, at least for now. She wasn't sure she could take her anger

out on Catra, she just needed… Time. Maybe a good talk with Bow??

She stumbled out, shoving on her jacket that had someone been hung up on a hanger without Adora ever hanging it.

She strolled into the cockpit to see a… scene.

"Uhm, what's going on?" Adora blinked in surprise.

"Oh, don't mind us, we're just out of power." Bow shot back, a slightly panicky look on his face.

"Bow! I've discovered a planet with high levels of energy wafting off of it, we should be able to find the power crystals on this planet." Entrapta shouted, peeking out from under the counter-thing.

"What." Adora blinked, rubbing her eyes tiredly. "Uhm… Do… Do I want to know?"

Bow shrugged.

Adora grumbled. "It's too early for this."
"THE CONCEPT OF TIME IS NOTHING BUT A SOCIAL CONSTRUCT AND THEREFORE DOES NOT EXIST IN SPACE!" Entrapta shouted after Adora as Adora turned around and left. "TIME REVOLVES AROUND THE SUN AND MOON MOVING ACROSS A PLANET! YOUR BODY IS JUST-"

Entrapta countinued to shout after Adora got out of earshot. Most probaby with complex words even she didn't understand herself. Adora wasn't sure, she wasn't awake enough to really process Entrapta's words.

She stumbled as she entered the kichen. (She thought she saw a flash of glittering pink hair and light chuckling from the corner, but nothing was there.)

Adora sighed, gently nudging the can open and breathing deeply at the sight of food. She gently scooped the canned goods and chomped on it, the food crunching dryly in her mouth. It was tasteless, but it worked for Adora.

(Catra walked in before backing out. She was distancing away from Adora, and Adora was fine with that. Although her heart longed for the feline, she was slowly breaking apart. Her best friends are separated and Catra is right there in her reach, and yet neither was reaching for each other.)

Adora shook her head, yelping in surprise as the ship suddenly shifted.
She hurried to the cockpit, finishing her dry food on the way. She slammed the door open, her eyes landing on Bow instinctively. (They flickered over to Catra who looked as frazzled as she felt.)

"What was that?!" Adora exclaimed.

"Did Horde Prime find us?!" Catra's tail was puffed up in alarm. (It was cute…)

"No, Darla made sure to keep us out. Oh, Darla's the ship by the way, she says hi. Darla, say hi!" Entrapta spoke.

"Hello." Darla said in her monotone voice.

"THAT DIDN'T ANSWER THE QUESTION!" Catra yowled (yowled? Since when could Catra yowl?)

"No, we're lurching because we don't have enough fuel, thus we're trying to make a landing on a nearby planet in hopes of finding some energy crystals." Bow explained patiently.

Adora blinked, the realization settling in like a chill in her bones. "That's- that's what you were talking about this morning-!"

Bow chuckled. "Yes, that is what we were talking about this morning."

Adora groaned, but it was lighthearted. The sound of Catra's laughter caused her soul to flutter in her chest.

"Okay, well, uhm.." Adora shuffled. "Do we know if the planet-"

"Has suitable conditions and energy levels? Yes, Darla's sensors picked it up! Hang on everyone!" Entrapta yelled before Adora's stomach swooped as the ship suddenly *dropped* .

***

"Hey Swift Wind. What are you doing?" Scorpia startled the poor horse so badly he threw a kick in the princess's direction. Scorpia yelped and ducked as his leg almost collided with her head.
"Woah! Swift Wind! I'm sorry!"

"Scorpia?" Swift Wind blinked in surprise. He retracted his leg sheepishly (horseihly??). "You shouldn't be sorry."

Scorpia scratched her neck nervously. "I mean, I can still be sorry, right?"

"Yeah, but like. I almost took off your head, so I have a reason to be sorry."
"Yeah? Well… I startled you! You, startled, went for my head, so that's my sorry."

The duo stared at each other before breaking into laughter. It was a break they both needed.

Swift Wind settled back down to stare at the sky.

Scorpia also moved to watch the sky quietly. "Soo… Whatcha doing?"

Swift Wind's ears twitched. "Ah, well… you know how I was connected to She-Ra?"

"...Yes?" Scorpia tilted her head slightly as if she had a complex math question in front of her. (Did she even know math? At least until Entrapta introduced it to her, so probably not.)

"Well I was trying… trying to talk to Adora… It's not.." Swift Wing shuffled, an mournful expression on his face.

"Maybe you just aren't looking at the right stars! Maybe that one over there, wait that's a moon. Maybe that one? Oh wait that's also a moon…" Scorpia rested her claw against the back of her neck nervously. "Aw jeez, have you ever realized how many moons this planet has?"

Above the duo, a single shooting star shone bright before it burned into dust.

***

"This place is supposed to have crystals?" Catra asked, her nose wrinkled in thought.

Adora had to agree with her, the planet was pretty much a barren wasteland.

"No, my tracker pad is also picking up a signal!" Bow exclaimed. "Come on!"

"Seriously? What even is your tracker made out of?!" Catra exclaimed, moving away from Adora quickly. She was grateful Catra seems to have changed, although Adora… well Adora wasn't exactly sure what to think. She's mostly been avoiding Catra, but it *hurts* to avoid her.

Adora shook her head. She was being left behind, so she rushed forwards ro catch up with Bow and Catra. (Entrapta stayed behind with the ship.. honestly Adora was fully expecting that by the time they get back, the ship would be all taken apart.

"That's-" Catra's words startled Adora out of her thoughts.

Adora glanced up, gaping at a huge tower that loomed over them. It was sleek in design, and very futuristic. It was oddly familiar…

"Isn't that one of Horde Prime's…?" Catra whispered, glancing around as if someone could hear her.

Bow nodded. "It's how he starts his conquering of worlds, it's the very first sign of Horde Prime."

Adora gasped. "That's what he's doing to Etheria!"

Catra winced. Then she suddenly stood straighter, her ears flicking downwards. "The ground here is more unstable, we need to be careful."

"How did you even hear that through the helmet… you know what? I'm not even going to try to reason." Adora shook her head slowly.

(They had no reason to trust Catra, right?)

Adora took a step towards the tower, ignoring Catra's cry of panic.

The ground below her shifted, and Adora froze. The trio stood in silence for a solid minute.

Adora met Catra's eyes that was sparked with fear. (Adora's never seen Catra *scared* before.) Bow too, looked nervious.

Adora breathed a deep sigh of relief. She slowly shifted her weight back to get off the ground, but in doing so caused the floor underneath her to suddenly shift again. Once again, Adora froze in hopes of the same tactic working again.

Spoiler alert, it didn't.

And Adora was sent sprawling downwards.

(Distantly she heard as she tumbled down into darkness was Catra's screams and Bow's yells.)

She crashed to the ground with a hard fall, and pain swarmed her vision. She stumbled, glancing upwards to see Bow and Catra worriedly peering over the edge.

Adora glanced around, the clearing was littered with rocks and a cave entrance opened up wide before her, a glowing light emitting from deep within.

"Adora!! Are you okay?!" Bow's panicked voice called from above.

"Yeah! I can see light! I'm going to go towards it!" Adora exclaimed back to Bow.

"NO! DON'T GO TOWARDS THE LIGHT!" Bow shouted back, even more panicked than before.

Adora blinked, realizing how *wrong* what she had said was. She turned to stare at Bow above her.

"IT'S NOT THAT KIND OF LIGHT!" Adora shouted back.

Adora could see Catra's gleaming eyes staring down at her from above, she appeared… worried even.

Adora blinked, shaking her head. *Nahh, she could go towards the light… probably.*

"We'll try to get down there! Stay still!" Bow's voice yelled from above, Adora hummed, not listening, and strolled towards the light.
When did it get so dark?

"Adora!"

(Did something hit her head?)

Adora woke up to loud voices and bright, glowing lights. She squinted, staring at nothing as faces swimmed in view.

“Glim-” Adora swallowed. Since when did her throat feel so dry and scratchy? “Glimmer? Bow? C- Catra?”

The faces above her that seemed familiar and also *wrong* glanced in the distance, obviously confused.

Noises damped her senses, overwealming her ears with high pitched ringing sounds. She resisted the urge to cover her ears with her hands, and only grit her teeth in response.

“Why did you-!”

“I didn’t think-!”

“Bad-!!”

“Why did she-”

Unfamiliar voices filtered through her ears, she didn’t recognize them at all.

“Who…?” Adora mumbled, her eyes slowly moving towards the faces. Lights blurred together in a swirling storm as she slowly moved to look at the travelers (?).

One of them had curly blonde hair and bright yellow eyes. Another had a hood over her head and dark brownish-red eyes staring into Adora's soul. The last one wore some strange, techical eyepath leaving only one of his (her?) eyes viewable. His blonde hair was lighter than the curly girl's hair, however it was still very curly and the two seemed like siblings. Finally, there was some kind of… owl creaure that tilted its head upon meeting Adora's eyes.

"Owww-" Adora winced, pulling herself up and rubbing her eyes.

"Don't move a muscle." One of the travelers, the one with the hood warned her.

"Huh?" Adora blinked in surprise, instictively freezing upon hearting the (unfortuntely) common warning tone.

"You're going to tell us why you are here and what master you serve." The tallest warned, he hands appearing from where they had rested behind her back to reveal- metal hands?

Adora yelped in surprise, backing up until her back hit a wall behind her. “Wait-wait-wait-wait-!” Adora yelped. “I’m not an enemy!”

“Then who do you work for?!”

Adora blinked, thinking. “Uhm… I don’t work for anyone?”

“DO NOT LIE TO US!”

Adora winced. “Err… I’m against Horde Prime, does that help?”

“No.” The tallest furrowed her brows.

The one with a patch spoke up. (Oh, it WAS a she!) “Well, if she’s against Horde Prime, then she’s not one of our enemies.”

“It’s going to have to take more than just that to convince me.” The tallest muttered.

“Jewelstar-” The blonde haired girl spoke up.

“Don’t.” Jewelstar, one one with hood over her head, spoke up. “Starla, you cannot be trusting of her!”

The blonde women visibly sweated. “She doesn’t seem like she is with the Horde anyways.” Starla, Adora assumd, pointed out.

“Yeah, but you can’t be too sure.” Jewelstar shot back.

“Uhm- I don’t think I caught your names.. I’m Adora!” Adora introduced herself bright.

“Starla, the untrusting one is Jewelstar, and this is Tallstar.” Starla introduced them all. “We are the Star Siblings.”

Adora smiled. “It’s nice to meet you all, but uhm.. What about the.. owl..?” Adora gestured to the owl.

“Her name is Glory.” Starla explained.

“I- see… Well then, nice to meet you all.. Uhm- we’re looking for crystals to power a ship..? Might you have seen.. any..?” Adora glanced around.

“We’re looking for some of those crystals also.” Starla explained. “We can go look together!”

Adora smiled. “Yeah, but I also have some friends I need to bring along with us… if that’s okay?”

Starla looked excited at the thought of more people.

***

“ADORA!” Catra growled angrily her tail dragging behind her as she and Bow strolled across the baren landscape, Bow ahead of her following his tracker thing as the duo wandered what felt like endlessly.

Eventually, however, they stumbled on a cave entrance, and Bow stopped to gesture towards it. “The signal of the crystals should be underground.” Bow mumbled out loud.

“Oh great, underground. So then we can get crushed by rocks?! Do you all have like no safety precautions?!” Catra accused, recalling in her mind of Sparkles. It strangely brought a sense of

sadness to her heart, she shook her head. She couldn't be sad now, she had to be strong.

"No, no we do not Catra. Thank you for asking." Bow nodded seriously, already moving inside the cave with purpose.

Catra shook her head as she groaned. "You guys are all just nerds."

Bow's eyes sparkled. "And now you are one of us now!"

Catra hissed. "I refuse to join your.. nerd squad."

Bow chuckled. "Too late."

Catra groaned loudly, her voice reverberating as the duo trudged along the tunnels.

Bow chuckled at her antics. He didn't pry or try to make fun of her any more, and that just made Catra respect him even more.

"Hmm… Y'know Arrow Boy, out of all the people in your group, you confuse me the most." Catra mumbled outloud.

"You've mentioned that before." Bow mentioned. The cavern ceiling above them became a light, warm rock gray.

"I have? Oh." Catra frowned. "Well then. Eh."

Bow stared at Catra, his eyes moving down the smallest bit to give the look of being unimpressed.

Catra already had bounced ahead, most in embarrassment. (To Bow, it was strange thought, to think of the 'almighty force captain' being embarrassed). Bow chuckled quietly following Catra deeper into the cave system.

Adora had been talking to the star sisters. Apparently they had been fighting against Horde Prime a long time, and was also

looking for crystals to power their ship. They had arrived here because this planet had those crystals. They had been living as refugees after their planet had been destroyed, planet hopping around.

They also seemed to know She-Ra, but only as a myth.

"She-Ra never existed! No one would ever go and willingly fight against Horde Prime!" Was a common argument made.

It twisted Adora's gears, and no one seemed to believe Adora saying she was She-Ra.

The trio led Adora down the cave, their owl, Glory, fluttered before them. But just as suddenly rushed back in a flurry of feathers.

Instantly, the trio was on guard, but Adora looked at Glory in hope. "Is it my friends? A girl with cat ears, a boy with a bow and fluffy curly hair?"
Glory stared at Adora with a bewildered expression as if she wasn't sure how Adora had known that.
Adora, however, was feeling better. "Those are my friends! Can you lead me to them??"

Glory started, flapping her wings and taking off, Adora close on her heels as she ran towards her friends.

Eventually, she could hear familiar voices and footsteps as she rounded the corner, slamming into something warm. Instantly, her arms came to hold the person upright, stepping back to realize who exactly Adora had stumbled into.

"Catra! Bow!" Adora exclaimed, hugging Catra, purely because she was closer. (That's all. Seriously.)
Catra's eyes widened in shock. "Uh- Adora? It's that bird again-!"
Catra hissed at Glory, Adora, however, stepped between the two. "Don't, Glory is a friend."

Catra still had a hint of suspicion in her eyes as she regarded Adora. "You trust that *thing* ? You and your friends, one day, you'll

get backstabbed.”

Ouch , that hurt. Adora knew Catra didn’t mean for it to hurt, but she couldn’t help but recall past memories of her and Catra. “I- okay, first of all, Glory is not a ‘thing’. She’s a she! Second of all, we’re not alone, they should be- there they are!”

The star sisters finally caught up, panting.

“Adora- hey wait up!” Starla exclaimed, kneeling over to catch her breath. Jewelstar had much more energy, and Tallstar looked indifferent.

“So, these are my friends… Catra, and Bow.” Adora gestured to the two of them. The trio blinked at Adora then at Catra and Bow.

“I get the feeling that the cat does not like us.” Tallstar noted out loud.
“Like you? Pft, I don’t **trust** you.” Catra shot back with venom injected in her tone.

“Well neither do we.” Jewelstar shot back. “But we’re uniting because both of us require those crystals.”

Catra’s tail fluffed up. “Get those crystals??”

“Catra-” Bow spoke up, Catra glaring at Bow before taking a deep breath. Her tail slowly lowered getting less, and less defensive. Adora felt a spike of… *some kind of emotion* , in her heart.

Adora shook her head to rid herself of the emotion, focusing forwards silently. “We need to look for the crystals, Bow, do you have the signal?”
Bow nodded. “I do, come on.”
Bow moved forwards, holding his tracker pad aloft before him.

***

Micah stood before an assembled crowd. Shadow Weaver shot him a look as Micah endlessly paced back and fourth.

“Micah, do sit down and stop pacing.” Shadow Weaver told her old student. Micah glowered at her silently.

Shadow Weaver sighed, resting her head on her hands.

Mermista groaned dramatically. “Are we really going to be forced to watch you endlessly pace for the next years? This is supposed to be a meeting, not a, whatever you’re doing.”

Micah sighed, sitting down finally. Mermista groaned.

“I’m glad that is now sorted!” Perfuma nodded, clapping her hands once together.

Spinerella slammed her hands on the table. “We need to talk about strategies.”

And the meeting began.

***

In the abyss and darkness in space, a head is raised and turned to point. Staring blankly in the darkness of space, eyes unblinking in waiting.

They did not move, not even once, still standing, blankly watching from behind her cage. Cables glowed and flashed with green light.

“Hmmm?” A chessboard is sat in front of him, and he lazily studied it. “Do you, see something?”

The caged bird shook her head slowly.

He smirked, lazily moving a piece forward.

The Queen.

But- he did not account for one more piece.

A single white rook.

***

"We're here." Bow pointed out, lowering his tracker pad down and pointing straight ahead towards a huge thick clutter of pink crystals that pulsed with power.

"That's it? How are we supposed to drag that back to the ship??" Catra exclaimed, crossing her arms angrily as she observed the sight. Crystals crowded every surface, making the cave shine in an unnatural light.

"No, those smaller ones are the crystals we're looking for." Starla pointed out to the big pink rock. "The ones that are growing from that rock. Those are the ones that power spaceships."

"Well then, this should be easy." Catra rushed forwards, ignoring the exclamination from Jewelstar and Bow.

As soon as she touched the big crystal, the ground shook, slowly moving upwards at an odd angle. Crystals shook and shattered on the ground, leaving shards of pink crystal sprayed out on the floor like shattered glass.

"Catra-! Are you okay??" Adora exclaimed, having had moved quickly to stop their only exit from being locked up. Jewelstar also had moved to help hold the crystal that threatened to trap them.

"Uh- yeah!" Catra's voice exclaimed, only her ears could be seen from where Adora stood. "I can almost get the crystals- hold on!"

“Catra- no!! It’s too dangerous!” Adora exclaimed, she desperately wanted to chase after Catra, but she couldn’t let them become trapped. Bow, however, moved over as if he was going to help, stumbling as the ground shook.

The cavern of glowing purple and pink crystals rumbled as chunks of rock crumbled down. Adora could only helplessly watch as Catra was engulfed in dust. Her heart stabbed in pain as she could only watch as her best friend (why did that word hurt her inside) vanished.

“Catra, please be safe..” Adora mumbled to herself as she struggled to hold up the rock that tried its best to crush her into a pancake.

Adora grit her teeth, a sudden, familiar surge flashing through her and she lifted the rock up with renowned strength. She panted, the rock pressing down against her lifted, and she turned to stare at the hole that she had created.
“The power of… She-Ra..” Starla murmured in surprise as the blonde watched in shock.

***

Swift Wind’s head jerked up in surprise and shock, bringing the gazes of everyone in the room.

“She Ra- I felt… I felt… She-Ra..” Swift Wind smiled (As much as a horse could) with hope.

Instantly people’s eyes brightened.

***

Adora grit her teeth, twisting around to go and help Bow get Catra, but was surprised to see Catra sliding out of the rising landmass, clutching several gems protectively in her uniform. Bow nocked a rope arrow, ready to shoot, but Catra didn't need it, easily jumping off, using her claws to slide down to the ground level. Rolling and running after Bow to get to the safe zone.

"Come on, come on! Quick!" Jewelstar exclaimed, gesturing as Catra and Bow jumped inside the entrance Adora had made. collectively, everyone breathed a sigh of relief.

"Catra-! Are you okay!?" Adora asked worriedly checked Catra for injuries. She was thankfully unharmed.

"I- yeah. I got the crystals." Catra proudly displayed her haul. Adora easily reached down to grab two and handed them to the Star Siblings in thanks. Catra stared at Adora silently.

"Thank you." Adora thanked the siblings quietly.

"We didn't do anything-" Starla pointed out before Adora shook her head.*

"You led us to the crystals, you told us your story. That is enough for me." Adora smiled.

Catra narrowed her eyes, Adora made sure to step in front of her scalding gaze.

Bow chuckled, and the star sisters smiled at Adora.

"Thank you, otherwise, we would've been stuck on this planet," Starla explained smiling.

Adora chuckled, locking eyes with Bow who also grinned.

The two groups set off, promising to try and get back in contact if both survive.

(Bow laughed at something Catra said. Adora couldn't help but smile. They were missing someone first...)

Chapter End Notes

I will say, I have someone dear to me in the hospital because they have cancer, so just to be warned, this is without editing so if you see mistakes... sorry!

Forgiveness

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora talk, they're slowly working out their differences!

And the heroes have arrived!

Chapter Notes

HIII!!

Guess who's back~

AND GUESS WHAT FIC IM FOCUSING ALL OF MY ENERGY INTO?!
YA BOY! THIS ONE!! WOO

I'm still trying to get into the flow of things, so if things sound broken and un-canon like, my apologies. I probably will go through this fic once I completed it to work out on some of the less cannon-like parts.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The ship flashed through the unwavering space of the galaxy as they moved along.

Catra paced along the edges of the room, her tail swinging behind her as she moved across the slick surfaces of the ship.

She’s been adapting slowly, slowly regaining that trust she once had. Those bonds she once knew.

Maybe things were different this time… (A certain purple-sparkling princess flashed through Catra’s mind. The first person who reached out to Catra first, not even Adora. Did Catra… have a

bond with her? That thought wasn't as terrible as Catra would've thought…)

"Catra?" Bow's voice spoke up, startling Catra out of her pacing rage.

"Ah-!" Her tail fluffed up and she twisted to stare at Bow.

Bow raised his hands. "My bad. Sorry. But- you look anxious."

Catra sighed. "I- a little..? I don't know how to describe it-"

Bow settled down, criss-cross and tilted his head listening intently.

Catra winced. "I forgot that you guys are always so… uh-"

Catra gestured to where Bow sat in vague gestures as if it explained everything. "This."

Bow chuckled, but didn't say anything else.

Catra sighed, returning to pacing. "If you think I'm going to start singing, you're going to be wrong."
Bow laughed again. "Listen- the only one who sings is Seahawk, so unless you want to start singing shanties-?"
Catra's eyes narrowed significantly as she scoffed. "Uh huh, no thank you. I will not… sing- urgh." Catra mimicked throwing up, her ears flicked back as she gagged.

Bow laughed, pausing in his fiddling with his bow for a moment to glance at Adora who had walked in and had been watching the two with a fond expression.

"Hey. Did I miss much?" Adora asked, sitting next to Bow and facing Catra as she sat down. She cast a glance in Entrapta's direction before focusing on Catra and Bow fully.

Catra stiffened. She's been doing it a lot whenever Adora appears, (why? Catra's not even sure herself.) maybe she is just startled

and uneasy at seeing her friend-turned-enemy-turned-forced-ally. (?)

Catra wasn't sure where she and Adora stood.

(Bow was constantly tired of the tension. Sometimes he wondered if this is what Adora had to deal with. Though… maybe not as much sexual tension. But- at least during when Glim and him fought. Bow suddenly felt a pang of empathy for Adora.)
Catra's tail flicked as she glanced at Adora.

"Oh, nothing much." Bow said casually, moving over to let Adora have some space.

"Cool. What are we talking about?" Adora leaned forwards, (it was unfairly cute) and listened.

"Catra I think is anxious the more we go towards the fleet." Bow said, leaning back. "That and I think it also has something to do with you returning to She-Ra."

Catra twisted to glare at Bow. "You-"

Bow raised an eyebrow. "Am I wrong though?"

Catra winced, unable to shoot back a witty reply.

Bow sighed, glancing at Entrapta. "I think I'll leave both of you here. You two need to work out on your… tension." Bow waved in their general direction. "If you don't, it might get in the way of our rescue."

Adora frowned. "We don't *have* tension."

(What a lie. Even Catra could see the suspicious glances from Adora when Adora thought Catra wasn't looking. The small protective gestures to Bow that CATRA used to have. Adora seemingly holding back info when talking to Catra.)
Bow stood up and walked off to chat to Entrapta, leaving Catra and Adora alone.

Adora frowned, watching as Bow left. “Bow! Get- urgh.” Adora sighed heavily. “Bow and trying to fix everyone’s problems.”

“Is ours unable to be fixed?” Catra winced internally when she spoke up, seeing with pain the expression on Adora’s face.

Adora winced externally. “I hope it could be.. but- how can I easily trust a friend-turned enemy? You’ve changed… yes, but… is it enough?”
Catra stiffened in offense, but she couldn’t revoke that. It was a fair point that Adora did bring up, unfortunately.

A tense silence flit between the space between the two of them. They both remained silent as they regarded each other.

“You- do have a point…” Catra admitted, a bit hard. Swallowing the stone that was lodged into her throat. “I- blegh. Arrow Boy always makes admitting things seem so *easy* .”

Adora mumbled out a weak laugh as Catra made a face.

It reminded Catra so much of the good old days. (She missed them, as much as she denied it.)

“Catra… I know that- well.. differences, but..” Adora sighed and continued on. “But, you have changed. Whether its a good one or bad one… I’m not sure. But- I hope its a good one. I- I miss when we were friends.” Adora admitted outloud. That caused Catra to jump in surprise.

“You- you do?” Her mind raced. “Then… why?”
Adora’s expression came dark as she knew what Catra was asking. “Because I couldn’t watch as the people who were kind to me, *die* around me! Losing their homes like you and Kyle, Lonnie… A good amount of soliders in the Horde who lost their families!” Adora exclaimed, her shoulders dropping as she told Catra full of emotion. “I couldn’t- I didn’t want to be a part of the reason why they lost everything.”

That familiar feeling of hate of the unfairness of everything rose within Catra, but for one of the rare times, Catra pushed it down again instead of usually embracing it.
She must have had a strained look on her face because Adora glanced away from Catra awkwardly.

The two sat in silence as they regarded each other silently.

"Uh-" Catra winced at how awkward it was.

"Y-yeah…" Adora cleared her throat before continuing. "I wanted to talk to you about… well, everything."

Now, Catra is not known to feel fear before, but those words. They instilled fear into her.

She swallowed, hard, her eyes staring at Adora silently. "Uh- every…thing?"

Adora sighed. "Everything."
Catra winced again.

"Catra." Adora said, drawing Catra's gaze to her. "I think what we need to do is… well, sort everything out."
Not everything… Catra thought bitterly. She would (probably) take her hidden feelings to the grave. "Fine." Catra said out loud, hoping she didn't sound as disappointed as she felt.

Adora sat in silence, watching Catra with an intent and piercing gaze. Catra couldn't help but stare at her beautiful blue orbs back in a memorized trance.

"Catra." Adora said after a moment. "Everything you've done…"
Catra startled from her trance at Adora speaking.

"I- I don't think I'll be able to forgive you, but- you've changed from that ship." Adora said after a moment of observing Catra. "I don't know what happened on that ship, but- you've changed."
Catra winced at the thought.

“I think… I could forgive you, just not yet.” Adora concluded. “And- I’m sorry…”

“Huh?” Catra imagined many scenarios, but never Adora apologizing to *her* !

Adora gave Catra an apologetic smile. “I’m glad your safe though.”

Now that, that was something Catra couldn’t wrap her head around. Adora had been worried about Catra??

Unlikely. Catra at least doubted it.

“Why?” Catra said calmly, her ears flicked on her head.

“Huh?”

“Why were you worried about me, your enemy, in the first place?”

Adora frowned. “Because we had been friends, and I worry about friends…”
But not me, Catra’s mind supplied. *Never me.*

Adora sighed. "Catra- look at me, please."
Catra glanced up to meet Adora's face, but couldn't force herself to look into her eyes. (She couldn't.)

"No- my eyes. Catra." Adora said, her hand cupping Catra's chin and lifting her face to stare directly into Adoras.

"I still *care* about you Catra. You betrayed my trust, but you are still my childhood friend. I will always care about you."
Catra made a strange noise, she felt like her throat was being clogged up.

Oh wait, Catra was crying.

For the first time in (weeks? months? years?) a long time, Catra exploded.

She cried and cried, and Adora was there to catch her.

And both would deny it later, when Entrapta called, but when they held each other, it felt like their world had become whole again.

But right now, their world was just them.

(And no one else.)

***

"Tch. A miscalculation." He scoffed as he examined the one trapped in a tank.

And so, he got to work.

[A ship appeared on the horizon. They are here.]

Chapter End Notes

Bow: Hey. I bet some cash that those two will end up dating before we defeat Horde Prime.
Entraptra: They weren't before???
Bow: ...

MEANWHILE:

Glimmer: ... Something just happened. Who made a bet against me-

The Fleet

Chapter Summary

> The group has arrived, get split up, and thrown into the worst situation possible.
> (Aboard a ship that everyone there wants them dead.)

Chapter Notes

> Apologizes for going so far off canon, (I know this is canon-divergent) but a lot of my mistakes are me not having watched 'Save the Cat' for so long and fumbling over myself. :P

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Bow was anxious.

Who wouldn't be when you were saving the person you loved cared about from an evil manic who controlled all of space. I mean, come on, a typical Tuesday!
…

Yeah no Bow was terrified.

He couldn't help but worry. Was Glimmer okay? What was Horde Prime doing? What would they encounter??

Well, he had a guess.

They had appeared at the edge of a small fleet of ships that surrounded a nearby planet, leaving the largest ship unattended.

"Entrapta, what's going on?" Bow slid up next to the purple haired princess.

"Hordak's fleet has reached huge amounts to be able to easily overwhelm us with blaster canons which could tear our ship apart

and leave us stranded again and slowly dying as our oxygen! Not to mention the size of the mothership and the controls over all of the-”
“Okayy, and I’m stopping you there.” Bow cut Entrapta off, taking her walkie talkie from her hands. “So, big ship dangerous. Let me guess, that is where we need to go.”

“Yyess…?” Entrapta nodded.

Bow sighed. “Nothing is ever easy is it?”

Handing Entrapta her walkie talkie back, Bow moved to turn on the intercom.

“Hey Adora, Catra, once you are done with your talk, come to the control room. We need to make a plan.” Bow said, holding the button and hearing his voice in the distance. He turned it off and turned to Entrapta. “Can you do a scan of the ship to gain possible layout?”

Entrapta’s eyes glowed. “I thought you would never ask!!”

She started doing her fast typing and rapid clicking she does when she gets in the zone.

Bow used the time to study the ship for possible weaknesses. He couldn’t see any, but that ship was very advanced. It twisted and flowed in a cycle, neverending circles around a big green-like spire.

“Hey Bow, what’s u- oh what in Brightmoon is that-?!” Adora shrieked in shock.

“Horde Prime.” Catra said darkly. “His main ship. That’s where Sparkles and I was at when we were first taken.”

Bow turned to see the two standing shoulder-to-shoulder to stare at the fleet. That was good, they seemed more relaxed than Bow had ever seen since Catra first came onto the ship.

“I got it! Look at this design!” Entrapta shrieked in excitement, turning Bow could see a 3d model of the giant ‘mothership’ floating in front of Entrapta.

Catra winced as she stared at it. “... We need a plan.”

“Yeah. I was hoping you could help us Catra? You’re the only one here who has been on that ship.” Bow turned to Catra with a apologetic smile. “I know you have bad memories, but- we’re going to need all the help we can get.”

Catra let out a drawn, low, hiss. “...”

She glanced at Adora, then at Bow and her eyes flicked towards Entrapta silently. “Fine… Let me see it.”

Catra stalked forwards to study the ship. She pointed near the bottom of the big spire. “This should be where the prisons are. I suspect that is where Sparkles is being held.” With a glance at Adora she sighed. “Horde Prime is at the top of the spire… I know you idiots are going to try and face him. You can’t. He has clones of himself patrolling the hallways. You’ll have to go stealth, but even then that is a risky play.”

Catra moved around the ship hologram. “... Entrapta I can feel your gaze on me.”

“Where is Hordak?” Entrapta slowly asked.
Catra twisted around and Bow could understand. Entrapta wanted to look for Hordak? THEIRS? (world, it sounded strange to stay ‘their hordak’.)

“Hordak… you mean from the Fright Zone?” Catra blinked. “That Hordak?”
Entrapta nodded.

“Uh- let me think. He should be going through rehab in one of the outer chambers… Yeah, this one.” Catra tapped a small room on one of the outside rings to the South.

Entrapta nodded, determination in her gaze.

“So, we go as a group? First Hordak, then Glimmer, maybe pay Horde Prime a visit, then leave?” Bow suggested.

“No.” Catra shook her head. “We should split into teams. Entrapta and I can go look for Hordak while you and Adora go get Glimmer.”

Her voice left no room for discussion and she sounded like a full on leader. (Which isn’t surprising since she was.)

“Catra- is this a good idea?” Adora started and Catra shook her head.

“No, its not. But I am the only one who knows exactly where Hordak is in the rehab room. Plus, Entrapta and I will be closer to the ship, and someone need to protect the lovebirds.” Catra said scathingly as if she had no room to argue.

Adora winced, drawing her hand back.

Catra winced at her own tone but didn’t say anything.

…

Nevermind there is the tension between the two. Bow was wondering where it went!

“So… where are we landing the ship?” Bow broke the silence between the two.

“Here.” Catra tapped a large room on one of the large circles circling the spire, just west of where Hordak was. “This is the ship bay, mainly the supplies. Not many, if any, patrols due to it just being unloading and reloading resources.” Catra explained as she paced, her tail flicking behind her. “We should be able to hide among the other stolen ships that they use to transport cargo. There we can either sneak off, or take out the workers.” Catra finished.

“So, we split up instantly, okay okay.” Bow took a deep breath. “And uh, Catra? How many are in a patrol?”

“Same amount that is in a patrol in the Fright Zone.” Catra said deadpanned back. “two to four.”

“2 2 4?” Adora tipped her head before it registered. “Oh.”

Catra mouthed something that looked like ‘idiot’ as she rolled her eyes.

“Entrapta, get us to that cargo bay.” Bow ordered, moving to the controls to carefuly examine them.

And to try and sort out his feelings.

Yeah, sure, Bow was still a tad bit angry at Glimmer, but at the same time, Glimmer was known to be impulsive and hotheaded. Added with the fact she became queen before being ready didn’t help her. Now the other parts of Bow, which overwhelmed his sense of anger was fear and worry. Worry about his friend and what he’s having to suffer on that ship. Worry that she is okay. (Worried that she was aliv- no, no. Bow was NOT finishing that thought.) That feeling of melocony settled in on his chest as Bow took a deep breath.

(Horde Prime better not have laid a FINGER on Glimmer. Otherwise Bow would have his- their? head.)

“So, we land this in this cargo bay, we take out the soldiers or just sneak by them, you two go and get Hordak and get back to the ship, and Bow and I go to look for Glimmer.” Adora rubbed her nose. “Sounds like every plan I have ever been a part of.”

Bow let out a surprised chuckle, coughing a bit. “I mean- didn’t you come up with half of those plans?”
“And you and Glimmer schemed against me!” Adora said in mock offense, gently shoving Bow away as Bow broke into a fit of laughter.

Catra was watched silently, and as Bow rubbed the tears of laughter from his eyes, he glanced at Catra.

"Catra? Are you sure you want to go back on that ship?" Bow tentatively asked, moving forward to an arms length away from Catra.

Catra was shaking, Bow realized now that he was up close. She was shaking, badly.

"N- no.." Catra admitted strangely honest. "B- but Sparkles needs us Arrow Boy."

Bow frowned. (Catra reminded him of when Glimmer saw the first ever scary thing and had shook with fear as she clung to his arm… Jeez, was Glimmer and Catra secretly like… long lost twins?)

"Catra-" Adora raised her hand but was stopped by Catra.

"No." Catra waved Adora off. "No. I failed to save Sparkles once, this is me trying again."

"... Do we want to go as a group to get Hordak, send Entrapta and Hordak back to the ship for backup, and then Adora, Catra and I go get Glimmer?" As much as it physically hurt to say that, Bow offered up.

"..." Catra remained silent, but clearly she was having an internal conflict.

"I think that's a good idea. Though, we should probably go as a group to make sure Entrapta and Hordak get to the ship." Adora suggested. "Then we can get Entrapta and Hordak in backup."

Entrapta looked strangely serious.

"I think that is a good idea." Bow agreed. "Then Catra can be with us to both help lead us to where Glimmer is and it can help with Catra's… uh- struggle."

Catra shot a halfhearted glare at Bow, steaming slightly.

“Catra…?” Adora started slowly.

“...” Catra sighed, seemingly coming to an end to her internal war. “Okay. Yeah.”

“We’ll be with you!” Bow cheered hugging Catra. “You’re one of us now!”
Catra groaned. “So you just adopt whoever you come across now?”

Silence.

“...” Catra glanced between them. “Really?”

Bow tapped his index fingers together and Adora was avoiding the cat’s eyes.

Catra threw her hands in the air. “Oh come on!”

Bow coughed. “I mean- thats how it worked..?”

“You two are the most incompetent people I have ever seen. You seriously *adopted* people?!” Catra sighed loudly. “I SERIOUSLY do not UNDERSTAND how we were losing to… YOU?!”

Adora chuckled awkwardly.

“Honestly? Same.” Bow said offhandedly.

“Hey- we’re here! Look at the energy that complimental shield is putting out agaisnt the natural forces of space-!” Entrapta suddenly exclaimed, drawing the groups attention as a huge gate dwarfed the ship.

“Oh, we’re here.” Bow mumbled, frowning at the sight.

***

Staying together meant that the group instantly lost someone. Mainly Entrapta.

Withing like, five minutes. A new record.

She spotted a familiar person stalking past, always far ahead of her.

(Hordak.)

Knocking out patrols along the way or dogding out of their path as she fled through the pure white halls towards her goal.

“These walls are pristine with super powerful artificial matter.” Entrapta couldn’t help but note down the ship as she ran determinedly.

(A clone spotted her running past and simply turned the other way. What did they gain from her anyways? (**Their biggest mistake**))

Entrapta slid into the room full of glowing green tanks. She ducked behind a pair of clones, waiting for them until they left, leaving only one clone left. (One very familiar one)

That remaining clone was wearing white clothing and was kindly waving to the other guards with a happy expression. (Which looked strange on his face.)

“Hordak?” Entrapta gasped at the (stranger? No, no, partner.)

***

Bow, Catra and Adora ran towards where Hordak would be.

They had lost Entrapta while going on the way to look for Hordak.

(Oh how foolish they were to fall for his trap.)

Swinging the door open to the rehab storage, the trio was not greeted by the glowing green tanks.
Instead they were greeted by a different sight.

Hundreds of Horde Prime stood before them, smirking as the sounds of footsteps are heard behind the trio.

Turning, they can only watch as more guards appeared, holding up guns to their throats.

“Its a trap!” Catra hissed out, angrily glaring at the guards.

“We’ve been expecting you, Catra~”

“Fuck.”

And chaos exploded.

***

The clone froze, turning to a familiar voice.

(Why was it familiar? That fuzzy feeling returned, threatening to swarm his senses.)

Turning, he met face to face with a girl, around half his height. Twin long purple matted ponytails swung behind her greesy and oily goggles and stained overals. All in various shades of purple, her magentia gloves torn and old as she stared at the clone with glowing eyes.

“Who are you? A fellow enjoyer of Horde Prime’s regin?” The clone gestured to the tanks around him.

Entrapta took a deep breath, her eyes growing sad, yet hopeful.
“Hordak?”
“Who is Hordak?”

“You!”

“I am not Hordak??”

“Hordak!” Entrapta yanked the clone behind a tank as the doors burst open, the guards eyes scanning the tanks with keen eyes as Entrata covered her mouth in fear. Hordak blinked at Entrapta in surprise, tilting his head and moving to stand but was yanked back down by Entrapta. But in doing so, Entrapta accidenally yanked a bit too hard, prying a small chunk of tech from the clone’s neck, severing his connection and he jolted in surprise.

“The purple one entered in here.” One of the guards scanned the area.
“Are we sure she even is a big threat? We already have the other three.” The second one pointed out. “Not like she can do anything about our hivemind anyways.”

Hivemind? The other three? WAIT- they have Catra, Bow and Adora? Oh no no- Entrapta kept her hand clamped over her mouth as the two guards argued, and glanced at Hordak in thougt. She leaned forwards, taking his weapon and launching herself forwards, shooting the gun at the two guards and effectively shutting their argument.

“Oh dear! Are you okay fellow civilians in Horde Prime?” Hordak exclaimed as he darted forward to gently tap them.

Entrapta turned to Hordak, noting the small sparks off of something on his neck. *He’s disconnected.*

“Okay Hordak, come on! We need to get out of here and help our friends!”

“Friends??”

Entrapta snatched Hordak's arm, dragging him along as the two ran to the ship, pausing as she saw the guard surrounding the ship with determination.

"I am afraid I do not understand what you are meaning to do, small purple one." Hordak said conversationally as if Entrapta hadn't just killed two guards.

Entrapta turned. "You are Hordak- do you remember that name?"

"No..?"

"Okay then…" Entrapta gasped as she dug around her pockets and yanking out a mircochip she had Hordak give her. "This could help!"

***

Catra hissed, swinging her claws at the foolish guard who had shoved her forward towards the throne room.

Bow and Adora were nervously glancing around as the trio was being dragged to Horde Prime himself.

Catra growled at the cuffs she had gotten so used to seeing. (Glimmer always needed them. Glimmer's comment of 'if Catra kept trying to be nice to her, she would be in need of these cuff' hit a mark now. Catra let out a weak chuckle at the remark as she recalled it.)

"Catra- they.. predicted us?" Adora leaned over to whisper.

Catra growled. "Of fucking course they would. He's fucking smart like that, annoying jerk."

Bow blinked in surprise, as if he wasn't expecting Catra to swear. Catra shot a glance at Bow like 'what did you expect?'

Adora made a small noise of complaint as a guard harshly jabbed her, forcing her away from Catra. (Catra saw red, she wanted nothing more than to tear that guard apart for touching her…)

"Move. Horde Prime wants to have a talk with *all* of you." The guard said, and the trio was being dragged along by the binds that connected the three of them.

Bow winced as one of them jolted his injured shoulder, from when the group had originally fought against the capture.

"Move." Catra glared at the guard that jolted Bow's shoulder drawing a slow hiss of pain from him.

It didn't help. Nothing was helping, they could only be forced along forwards.

(Familiar hallways full of pain and suffering. Familiar set of doors, where Catra KNEW who sat behind them.)

The doors swung open, opening to the white expanse of the throne room. Where on his throne, Horde Prime smirked from above.

"Oh, hello. Didn't expect to see the cat back so soon."

Chapter End Notes

Woo, next chapter is the CLIMAX! (or at least before all hecc breaks loose.)

Also yes, let Catra swear, just a bit. <3
(LOTS OF HEARTBREAK NEXT CHAPTER)

The Queen

Chapter Summary

> They found Glimmer... but at what price will they need to pay to get her back?
> (Spoilers, a lot of heartbreak and pain.)

Chapter Notes

> The moment all of you have been waiting for! Since we didn't get much of controlled!Catra, As much as I wanted to write more corrupted!Glimmer, I could not since I wanted this to be as canon as seemingly possible (like an alt au) and more of that. Obv I could've planned out more, but- OHOHOHO
>
> The pain was not in the start. Its always in the aftermath.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora glared at Horde Prime from where he leaned casually on his throne.

"Horde Prime." Catra spat with all the contempt she held, like venom injected into her voice. As if her words could end him on the spot.

"Catra. A long time no see hmm? Didn't think you would be so eager to return so soon." Horde Prime said in a calm voice.
"I don't want to be anywhere near a bastard like you." Catra hissed. "I'm only here for my friend."

"Your… Friend? The sparkly one? I doubt you were friends. She hates you." Horde Prime shot back.

Catra hissed as Bow spoke up. (She noticed that the guards removed her cuffs, but not the one on her ankle that tied her to Bow and Adora. Curse them.)

" *Our* friend which we know better." Bow shot back.
"Well that's stupid logic." Hore Prime said cooly.

"You are stupid logic!" Catra pointed an accusing finger at him.

"Catra-" Adora started but was cut off by Horde Prime.

"Wow, touchy are we?"

"Guys…?" Adora started again before Catra yelled back.

"What do you fucking think??" Her tail swung behind her angrily.

"Guys-!" Adora exclaimed, being once again drowned out by the argument.

Bow twisted his head to glance at Adora, who was staring off in teh distance with a horrified look on her face. Like all of her dreams had been crushed in one scene and left in a puddle in front of her. Heartbroken, sad, angry even. Craning his head, Bow couldn't see what she was looking at with such horror. "Adora..?"

"Why don't you just ask her?" Horde Prime spoke up, drawing Bow's attention back to the fight.

"What do you mean…" Catra glowered at the high strung ruler.

"Hello there, cat." Eerie, familiar words yet indecribably *not* echoed the room and Bow felt his heart *break* .

There, wearing white robes, sporting an uneven and half shaved haircut, with glowing green eyes stood Glimmer.

"Sparkles..?" Catra jerked back in surprise.

"No…" Bow could only stare at Glimmer in horror, feeling like the world was slowly breaking around him.

Her eyes held no familiar spark, only dark blankness that mimicked Horde Prime's eyes as she stared at the three of them.

“What did you do to her-!” Adora shouted, glaring at Horde Prime with fire in her eyes.

“Oh, I did nothing. She simply saw the beauty of our kingdom.” Horde Prime waved his hand calmly.

“Why do you fight him? We could all be on the same side here!” Glimmer parroted in that unnatural, echoing voice that was too similar to Horde Prime it brought shivers up Bow’s spine. She brought her hands to gesture to the room around them as she stepped forward calmly, peering down at the three people.

“Glimmer-! Snap out of it-” Catra exclaimed, pushing through her shock to do *something* .

The thing that was Glimmer (or the thing piloting Bow’s friend’s body) only tilted her head, her glowing green gaze turning to face Catra.

“Catra.” Glimmer waved her hand in an orderly fashion. **“She won’t hear your desperate cries. Why would she even waste time on her enemy?”**

Bow grit his teeth. “What about her friend then?”

Glimmer turned, and Bow swallowed hard at the sight. Now regretting speaking up and being met with those eyes.

“Oh, it's you. Bow, was it? She held you in high regards. A pity that I cannot share the same sentiments about someone who betrayed my trust.” Glimmer said in a cold tone. **“Why should I care about people who lied to me, who went behind my back anyways?”**

“You didn’t listen-!” Adora accused, shooting up and narrowing her eyes on Glimmers.

“You didn’t even try, *She-Ra* . You thought you were so high strung you could take on *anything* .” Glimmer raised an eyebrow. “ **Am I wrong?”**

Adora grit her teeth, glaring at Glimmer silently. “You are.”

“This isn't Glimmer.” Catra tried to console Adora.
“Glimmer is too stubborn to ask if she’s right or not.” Bow agreed, taking a deep breath. (It hurt to breath- oh god it hurt. His heart felt like it was shattered at the sight.)

“Now, now. Do recall that *people* can *change* .” The thing piloting Glimmer spoke.

“Yeah, but Sparkles is too stubborn and impulsive to change. She’s been pratically the same for *months* .” Catra pointed out, her eyes narrowed as the thing that was Glimmer stepped forwards.

“Hmm...” Glimmer turned to Horde Prime and gave a head tilt in Catra’s direction.

“Don’t you dare.” Adora growled, shifting to put herself between Catra and Horde Prime.

“Oh, assume too much now don’t you She Ra? But, you do remind me of a good idea. Catra, would you like to *join* us?” Horde Prime leaned forward on his throne, peering down at the trio.

Catra’s expression morphed into disgust. “What. No!”

“Well you don’t get a choice really.”

Thats when Glimmer moved, yanking Catra up with a tug. Glimmer was shorter than Catra, but just as strong, but once the chains connecting Catra to the other two was severed, Catra brought her back claws up to scratch the living daylights out of Glimmer. Using her back claws as leverage, she sumersaulted off of Glimmer and landed in front of her friends. But not before she saw the piece of tech on Glimmer’s neck.

Catra brought out her claws as she fell into stance.

Silently, Glimmer turned to stare at Catra with a scowl. Twisting her face unnaturally to fit a scowl more suited for Catra.

"Bow!" Catra twisted, using her back legs to throw off Glimmer's balance as she charged at them, watching as Glimmer skid across the smooth white floors. "Her neck!"

Bow jerked out of his broken, half awake stance, wincing as he watched Glimmer get thrown around like a ping pong ball. It took a moment to register what Catra was saying, but Bow gasped at seeing a small, hexagon-like thing embedded into Glimmer's neck.

Adora stood up, dragging Bow still attached to her up alongside.

"Duck!" Catra yelped, and Adora shoved Bow down, a guard (somehow?) sailing over their heads and vanishing into the chasm with a very familiar scream. (Wilhelm or whatever. Who calls a scream 'Wilhelm' anyways??)

Bow was forced to jump back as another guard slammed a spear right where he had been moments before, tugging on the chains between him and Adora painfully.

A sudden shaking of the spire had Bow and everyone else stumble, before it was over just as fast.

Glancing, Bow readied himself for close combat, something he was never good at but could do in a pitch. Lunging forwards, (dragging Adora for the ride) he met the guard head on, using the guard's spear to weaken the chains between him and Adora in an attempt to break it. It didn't work, but he did end up with a spear and a techy sword he tossed to Adora

A yelp of pain snapped the two out of their battle trance, and blinking awake, Bow startled at the knocked out guards that spread around them like battlefield. Sending a glance to Adora, Bow was startled at what he saw. A single tear ran down her glowing blue eyes, her blonde hair waved and glowed as she was locked into something behind Bow. Glancing behind, Bow was met with a horrfying scene.

Glimmer, holding up by the throat, a struggling and heavily injured Catra.

***

Before all hell broke loose, Catra was doing pretty well against Sparkles. Now, mind you, Sparkles wasn't throwing around those glittery pink bombs anymore, but regardless, Catra was doing well enough.

Dodge her reckless attacks, duck under her swinging spear, use her momentum to knock her off balance to deliver another scratch to the neck tech on her. It became like a pattern.

That was until Glimmer proved Catra wrong by *learning* . Instead of her lunging, she swept with her legs, sweeping Catra and drawing a startled yelp as Catra fought to stay on balance.

"Not so confident now are you kitty cat?" Glimmer mocked in that *voice* that brought shivers along Catra's spine as Catra grit her teeth.

"So you can learn, big improvement Sparkles." Catra shot back. One thing she was good at was battle talk.

Glimmer's hands clenched her staff more tightly as he lunged again, Catra using her momentum swung above her, landing on her back and pinning the pink queen to the ground. Catra leaned over, trying to pry the strange tech on her neck off, but was unsuccessful, only able to pry a bit off before the queen threw Catra off again.

"You are a horrible person. Do you really think that *they* forgave you?" The queen mocked as she threw Catra off.

Catra hit the wall with a dull thud as she slid. She stumbled up, wincing as every muscle in her body protested as she leaned

heavily against the wall behind her. Glancing at Sparkles, Catra couldn't do anything as a Sparkly train rammed right into Catra, pushing the wind out of her and throwing her head back, banging it against the wall.

Catra grit her teeth as she felt a piercing strike through her skull. A concussion probably. She strangely felt like the ground shook underneath her.

"Is… that.. all you've… got- Spa- Sparkles?" Catra coughed, weakly moving to scratch Glimmer halfheartedly.

The queen, as Catra is going to dub her, grit her teeth in a cruel grin. Her green eyes flashing for a moment as Catra's claws stabbed a bit of the tech. For a moment, Catra could see the flash of those annoyingly sparkly pink eyes before the shade of green covered them again.

"Oh Catra" The queen mocked, yanking up Catra and holding her up by the throat, drawing a pained screech from the cat as they squeezed. **"Your fighting the worng people. After all, you and I,"** she gestured to Horde Prime who was watching with amusement. **"are not so different are we?"**

Catra struggled, trying in vain to pull away from the calloused hands that held her up. Dark spots danced along her vision as she struggled, her tail swinging back and forth as she sputtered for air.

"You… need… to… do… more… than… that… Sparkles…" Catra gasped out between breaths as she was dragged and being held above the void. Her back claws left groves along the ground as she resisted the queen's hold.

"Goodbye, Catra."

***

Adora had been doing quite well, all things considered. Despite being handcuffed to Bow and using an unfamiliar sword.

It wasn't until she heard Catra's scream that Adora realized that there was something that could bring her all the dread and fear of the world. Catra, in pain.

Twisting around, Adora was met by a horrfying sight, (ignoring the dead guards around her and Bow). Catra, being held over the void by the neck, her face turning blue as she struggled to breathe. Her claws leaving marks across the white floor as Glimmer stood, emotionless, holding Catra up.

A surge of power shot through Adora, and through adrenaline, she lunged forwards.

"Adora!" Bow's voice was distant, muffled. Like it was under water or something.

Adora only had one thing in her mind. Save Catra.

Adora lunged, and in that moment, she was not Adora. She was She-Ra. She had Mara by her side, and all the other She-Ras before. All of them screaming out as Adora jumped forwards, snapping the handcuffs that tethered her to Bow in two.

She-Ra leapt, with the intent to save everyone at the same time.

She-Ra's glow covered Adora as she ran, adorning her with a new outfit as she swung her hair back, leading into one big ponytail behind her. Her cape was smaller, much more like a skirt as her armor grew on her chest and legs, leaving only from down her elbows exposed. The usual headband flourished on her head, holding back heer glowing blonde hair as she took on a glowing factor.

Glimmer could only turn, she couldn't react more than that, as Adora barreled towards her. She-Ra's hand ready to bring it down

on the controlled Queen.

Then, she brought her hand down, knocking out Glimmer with one good hit and catching Catra with her other hand. Holding Catra gently as the knocked out girl-cat made a noise of complaint, squinting at Adora.

"Hey… Adora…" Catra mumbled before she fell unconscious.

(Bow, watching this, was cheering her on. At least until she hit Glimmer good over her head. That jerked Bow forwards in response, yanking Glimmer away from the chasm before she could fall down.)

"Adora, we need to go!" Bow shouted, Glimmer thrown over his shoulder carefully with extreme care as he gestured for She-Ra to follow.

Adora, no She-Ra, startled at Bow being nearby so quickly. Jumping out of her daze, she nodded, leaping forwards in one bound. Punishing all who dare to stand in her way between her and that exit.

Thankfully, she didn't need to get lost on the way out, because by luck would have it, before the two fo them had successfully escaped the minefield of fallen guards, a large energy blast tore through the throne room. Tearing a hole into space and both Bow and She-Ra took a deep breath on instinct to hold their breaths. There, a familiar ship hovered where a purple haired princess gestured for them.

"COME ON GANG! ME AND WRONG HORDAK ARE HERE TO PICK YOU UP!" Entrapta shouted over intercome as she opened the bay doors for She-Ra and Bow.

Sharing a look, the two of them took a running start before jumping, She-Ra being able to make it to the ship while Bow didn't even get close.

Seeing this, She-Ra shoved Catra into the airlocked and jumped, yanking Bow and Glimmer into the bay just as it closed.

Panting, just as the doors shut tightly, She-Ra locked gazes with Horde Prime who rubbed his chin. A frustrated, yet strangely calm look on his face.

"Oh hello!" A cheerful voice spoke up, once the airlock did its magic and She-Ra gasped, Bow along with her as he coughed.

Glancing up, She-Ra felt her power waning, that adrenaline weakening to just a thread and she was suddenly Adora again.

Bow crawled forward, holding his hands over his stomach in pain. "Owww.."

Glancing up, Adora jumped, shakingly holding up the sword she had towards where a clone held his hands up in surrender.

***

Ask anyone, and they'll say the same thing. Entrapta was not a fighter. She cared more about learning then about anything else. Distracted far to easy.

But in that moment, the moment Entrapta realized that Hordak wasn't *Hordak* , she felt different.

Now Entrapta was never good at relationships. Always too deep into research to really care about them. But in that moment, Entrapta felt… hopeless. Sad for something she never even tried to pursue. A friendship.

Wait no, she had friends. Didn't she? Emily was a friend.. but-

Now that Entrapta thought about it, she never actually treated Emily like how Bow and Adora treated each other, or how Scorpia

treated… *her and Catra* …

She never acted like a friend. Her- her hyperfixation on technology lead her to be.. distant.

Why did she yearn to not be distant? When did her priorities change?

Maybe when she saw Hordak shake his head in confusion at the chip, maybe that was the moment.

But, something changed in Entrapta, that much was clear.

She didn't *want* to stay here and study the tech for once. For once in her life, she went *against* her wants.

She sighed, her shoulders sagging as she took a deep breath. "Okay, Hordak, I'm going to call you Wrong Hordak, anyways, you wanna come with me?"

The newly dubbed Wrong Hordak shrugged. Entrapta took that as a yes, and so, she grabbed his wrist and bolted to the ship. She wasn't a fighter, but when she was determined she was not a force to be reckoned with.

The two guards left to guard the ship learned that fact quick enough, two seconds flat and they're being thrown across the bay as the doors slip shut with a resouding crack as Entrapta sat at the pilot chair.

"Okay, Wrong Hordak! Hold on tight!" She dialed buttons and levers with praticed ease. "Darla! Start up!"

The sounds of the ship powering up accompanied the silence as Entrapta steered the ship out of the bay, thankful no ships were after her… yet. Gritting her teeth, Entrapta swung the ship to the spire, where her friends should be.

The first shot revealed a lot of nothing. Entrapta sighed.

“Darla, pull up the map.”

The glowing blue map appeared in front of her and she studied it, lowering the ship as she shot again. This time she hit her mark. Glancing back, Entrapta was thankful that Wrong Hordak didn’t see this.

“Get in! We need to leave!” Entrapta shouted, opening the doors for the two running people with two unconscious people over their shoulders. A question to ask another day.

Making sure that the two of them were inside, she shut the doors, raising the ship and having to bank right, hard, as a blast of energy hit the spire, just barely missing the ship. Seems like the defence has come back. Taking this into account, Entrapta swung the ship away, pulling it into max speed towards the old abandoned planet that the group had become stranded on. She pulled forwards, leaning the ship into speed as the rescue team took a sigh of relief as they exited the area of Horde Prime.

***

Glimmer was a prisoner in her own body.

A puppet as she beat up Catra, shooting insults to the girl that Glimmer had actually somewhat grown fond of since her time on the ship.

Her heart broke at seeing Bow’s horrified look at the *monster* Glimmer had become. No doubt how they would all see her. The one who brought Horde Prime here, the impulsive Queen who got the entire planet of Etheria *doomed* .

Noting Adora’s expression of rage and… Catra’s expression of… broken shock? Glimmer didn’t expect Catra to look so… sad at seeing her.

(Did Glimmer really form a bond with her enemy? Though, wouldn't that, by an extent, include Adora as well?)

She cheered as She-Ra lunged forwards, but was confused on the lack of her sword. Though… there was another sword which seemed to be made out of pure energy.

Glimmer welcomed the calm darkness, relaxing into the Abyss that welcomed her with open arms.

Somewhere where no green eyes of Horde Prime constantly watched her, as she was chained by chains and piloted by the emperor.

(She saw a war back home. He was controlling them like her- She had to warn them- She had to-)

But her battle wasn't over.

No. To her, she's only begun to fight back.

Chapter End Notes

WOOO

How's that commenter? (YEAH I KNOW WHO YOU ARE BESTIE!)
But now, we get into the aftermath next and ohoho, I hope you are ready for a ride.

The Gang's back together again! (Kinda)

Chapter Summary

> The Best Friend Squad now has their member back and they're all in one place again!
> (Woo!)
>
> Now the aftermath is what they need to get through to get their happy ending!

Chapter Notes

> Good news! This week is YOUR lucky week! This fic might be done by around next week Monday even!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra woke up in pain and agony.

Swiping at something far above her as she pulled herself out of the abyss that threatened to pull her back.

Unfortunately, she almost sliced Adora's face clean off by her sudden awakening. As she jumped up, thankfully (or not depending on how you view it), Catra instead knocked her head against the person who had been watching over her.

Which just so happened to be Adora.

"Ack!" Catra yelped, her hands movng to cradle her noggin as her tail curled around her.

"Catra!" Adora's familiar voice sounded above Catra, drawing Catra's eyes to stare at her.

"Hey Adora." Unlike the past ones, this one sounded geninue. "Glad to see you okay idiot."

Adora didn’t let Catra even open her mouth to respond before she threw herself and envelopted Catra in a hug, holding her close.

Heat radiated from Adora as Catra made small noises of surprise as Adora hugged her.

“Hey… Missed you too… What- what happen-end…. Sparkles!” Catra shot up at that, recalling what they had been doing. Still in Adora’s hold, Catra twisted her head over Adora’s shoulder, breathing a sigh of relief at seeing a passed out unconscious Sparkles as Entrapta along with Arrow Boy was fiddling with the strange techy thing on her neck.

Upon closer inspection, Catra frowned at seeing Arrow Boy’s crestfallen expression. Broken, he looked sad. I mean, it was understandable, he obviously is in love with Sparkles. But-

Catra flashed back to the previous encounter, Sparkles words that were parroted through her mouth as she spat in hate at them. Her pure green eyes emotionless and unforgiving.

He didn’t take those words to heart… did he?
‘We’re the same after all, Catra’

She didn’t take those words to heart either… did she?

Adora was mumbling, Catra could feel her lips pressed against her shoulder as she mumbled into Catra’s clothing breathlessly.

“Wait…” Catra dug through her memories, only being able to uncover a golden flash. “that flash of light… was that-”

“She-Ra?” Adora pulled back, tear streaks had adorned her face as she stared at Catra wordlessly. “Yeah, yeah it was.”

Catra let out a surprised laugh. “So you can become She-Ra without the sword?”\

“Uh-” Adora squirmed as she held Catra at arms length.

"No, no she cannot." Arrow Boy spoke up. "She's tried, but she's too sad and stopped."

"Bow!" Adora proclaimed in offense, twisting her head to glare at Arrow Boy.

"What? It's true!"

Catra laughed weakly, choking as the door opened to reveal… A horde prime clone.

She jumped up, shoving Adora behind her and holding her claws out, her instincts acting out.

"Wait wait wait- Catra!" Adora didn't let Catra shove her back, instead, she fought Catra, eventually being able to hold Catra from charging the clone. "That's Wrong Hordak! A friend! He's not a part of the hivemind!"

Catra growled. "He's still dangerious."

Dark thoughts flashed through her mind, reminding her of her experience on the ship. But then… Catra felt… shame? Guilt? Something Catra does not often feel. But she felt it when she glanced at Sparkles, knowing full well that what Catra had to go through, Sparkles had it worse.

Since Catra was a 'guest', Sparkles was a 'prisoner'. Catra sighed as her claws dug into her arm. Sparkles would go ballistic if what the torture that Catra suspected she had to go through was true. (She really hoped not but… Trauma is a bitch.)

Adora sighed. "I know, I don't like him being here and neither does Bow." She whispered to Catra. "But, Entrapta insisted and well.. I think she's trying to cope for losing a friend." Adora confessed quietly.

Because both Adora and Bow had someone to chase after and… Entrapta didn't have anyone… at least not someone who WANTS

to come back… maybe… Catra knew Hordak, but she didn't have the same bond Entrapta had with Hordak.

(Catra had horrible flashbacks to when she took a weapon to her 'friend'. Maybe Sparkles was right. She didn't deserve forgiveness…)
Shaking her head out of her depressing thoughts, she gently shoved Adora away and hobbled up and over to Sparkles, leaning against the wall as her muscles screamed in pain.

"How is she?" Catra forced out, studying the peaceful expression on the Queen of Brightmoon.

"This technology is fascinating!" Entrapta started, pulling out her talking thing that Catra snatched before she could go on a rant.

Holding the talking thing, Catra clicked the on button. "Arrow Boy? Can you explain to me without going horribly off topic?"

Bow frowned, taking the walkie talkie thing Catra held up for him. He glanced at Entrapta who was focused on Sparkles before clicking the device on. "We have not done much. Deactivated her connection to the Hivemind and severed the device's power. But Glimmer hasn't… woken up, yet."

Catra frowned. She was horrible at comforting people, so she just gave Bow a pat. Not a gentle one, mind you, since Catra never grew up 'gentle'. So it made a clap noise as Catra brought her hand to bump Bow's shoulder, pausing when she saw his expression wince with pain.

"Are you…" Catra gestured to Bow's shoulder.

Adora facepalmed. "He's been avoiding self care in order to take care of Glimmer… Like *usual* ."

Catra let out a bark of laughter. "That checks out."

Adore made a noise of protest. "We're trying to stop him from avoiding self care Catra! Don't promote it!"

"Tsk." Catra smirked, her tail moving before she paused.

'you are a horrible person'

Her tail froze just as Catra had moved it to rub against Adora's chin. Instead, Catra retracted her tail slowly, but was caught off guard by Adora snatching her tail instead.

Catra shrieked in surprise as Adora held it gently and firmly. Staring into Adora's eyes (when did they get so… hypnotizing?) Adora sighed.

"Catra… can we… talk?"

***

When Catra was knocked out, it had been the most stressful situation Adora had ever been in.

With two of her friends, having both been in a nightmarish situation. Both undoubtedly would have nightmares to haunt them for the rest of their lives. Actually, Adora and Bow might even have nightmares that will affect them through their life as well.

One having been, well, turned against them and controlled by Horde Prime. The other…

Glancing at Catra, Adora had her answer. Beat up by someone she had bonded with, verbally abused and even *offered* to join evil when she was well aware that Glimmer probably didn't get the choice.

"Catra… are you okay?" Adora asked, turning on the feline once the two of them had moved to the other side of the room, out of earshot from Entrapta and Bow. (Wrong Hordak had left after seeing Catra having to be held back from attacking him.)

“Huh? Yeah.” Catra said, her eyes still lacking that usual luster.

“Catra, please.” Adora wanted to scream, wanted to drag every hurtful thought Catra was having and crush it right there.

“I’m.. fine.” Catra hugged herself.

Adora paused, her hand falling as she fell silent. Catra was being defensive. Adora really wanted it to stop.

“Catra, I.. Catra.” Adora took a deep breath. “You’ve changed. I saw that at the spire. When offered power, *you didn’t take it* . If I learned anything from my time in the resistance, its that trust is hard fought to be earned. You- you *proved* to me, to all of us, that you’ve changed.” Adora confessed. “You’ve shown me that you have changed… I forgive you for your past actions. Trust is harder to be reearned, but… I’m willing to take those steps to regain the trust I held within you.”

Catra had been looking at her, her eyes wide in surprise as Adora confessed. Adora’s gaze locked into Catra’s fluffy mass of hair.

Oh how much Adora wanted to run her fingers through it. (Despite it being a greasy, unwashed mass of tangles.)

“You should take a shower.” Adora blurted out, freezing at her words.

Catra was looking at her, and frowned. “You know how much I hate water.”

“Yeah fair…” Adora sighed, dragging her hand down her face. “I just think that, it might be nice.. for you, maybe.”

Catra’s ears flicked back in displeasure. “Yeah right.”

“Plus, no offense but you are kind of dirty. You haven’t even tried to take care of your hair since you first came on this ship.” Adora crossed her arms, gesturing to Catra’s hair.

"..."

"See?" Adora sighed. "If you don't want to- I understand but… I think, I think you should. I know how much you care about your fur, this is.. a good way to keep it clean."

Catra's shoulders slumped. "You're trying to get rid of me."

What? "What?!" Adora exclaimed outloud, her eyes being dragged to Catra from where they had been locked in on her hair.

"I'm a horrible person… You shouldn't forgive me." Catra repeated those hurtful words that Glimmer (The Queen as Catra and Horde Prime had called her) said.

Adora's hand moved on its own, moving to grip Catra's shoulder in an iron like grasp. "Yes, but we forgave you because we saw you change. Sure, yeah, you did some bad things, but, I mean, everyone does bad things once in a while!"

"Not you."

"I almost tried to kill Glimmer and Entrapta multiple times."

"Under First World tech."

"I let myself get manipulated by Light Hope."

"...What?"

"I went behind my friend's back and lied to her as me and Bow went to Beast Island… Not getting back in time to save our friends from Horde Prime."

"..."

"Heck! I almost ruined an entire town!" Adora exclaimed waving her hands. "You aren't the only one who's made mistakes. I know for a fact, that once Glimmer wakes up, she and Bow are going to

also have a talk like this.. We all have problems, but, I learned that the best way to deal with them is to face them."

Catra's head dropped as she stared at the floor. Adora moved her hand, gently cupping Catra's face and picking her chin up to look at Adora again. "We all make mistakes. We all are going to fix them again. Actions always speak louder than words, Catra. What you did, it's enough to show that you are on the path of redemption. Please, don't ever think of yourself being unable to be saved, or unworthy of forgiveness."

Catra let out a wet laugh. "You've grown soft Adora." She rubbed her eyes where tears fell unbidden.

"Yeah well, haven't we all." Adora leaned in, hugging Catra again and holding her close, relishing in the sensation of her best friend.

***

Was it a nightmare?

Probably not.

Glimmer hoped it was.

But at the same time, Horde Prime never forced her to watch anything… well, fake, before.

He took joy in watching Glimmer suffer.

(He called her 'the Queen', the strongest piece in chess. Glimmer fought back to keep herself. She would not be known as 'the Queen', no thank you. She was her own person despite how much Horde Prime tried to break her.)

But… watching those spiteful bug-like pests as they weaved and clung to the resistance people pained Glimmer.

She was grateful when Sea Hawk had noticed the bug, being able to push Mermista out of the way before it could latch itself onto her neck.

Thank fucking god.

But, no matter how much Glimmer looked, she couldn't see Adora, Bow, Catra, Entrapta… They weren't anywhere.

Did her warning not work?

But someone she did see?
Her father.

She screamed as she saw her father, there, *alive* . Fighting against the Horde with flashy magic. She cried out, tugging on the chains that held her in Horde Prime's grasp as she watched that annoying *bug* lunge forward to attach itself to her father.

(It never landed.)

She watched as he caught it, crushing it and tossing it.

(It was worse than when Glimmer saw Scorpia or when Frosta was bitten by those… *bugs* .)

She shivered as she felt that annoying pest squirm on her neck. She remembered the first time she was here, several green eyes staring at her as she struggled to pry that bug off of her neck. Those green chains locking her down, being unable to do anything as she could only writhe in pain and desperation.

(Adora, Bow… Please, please, *please* be okay. It was a mantra she repeated to herself. Over and over. *Catra, please say you warned them away, please Catra. Etheria needs them!*)

Glimmer had lost the ability to cry in the endless cycle of torture. It only persuaded Horde Prime to continue his *sick* and *twisted* games.

"Fuck you." Glimmer snarled at Horde Prime, baring her teeth aggressively like all the other times Horde Prime came to 'visit'.

Horde Prime laughed, his voice echoing throughout the space and leaving Glimmer's head feeling fuzzy and dizzy. **"Oh Queen, you should know that Emperor is of higher status."**

"Yeah like I fucking care or that I'm fucking going to bow to *you* ." Glimmer spat. "Die in the deepest, darkest hellhole you came from, *Prime* ."

Horde Prime smirked, taking careful steps until he was *just* out of scratching range. His favorite spot. So close, yet Glimmer couldn't even reach him. **"Oh. You're funny, your highness. So, you haven't seen it yet?"**

Glimmer glowered at him. "No, and I don't fucking care either."

"Pity. Your pathetic warning didn't work." Horde Prime's words sent shivers down Glimmer's spine.

"What." Glimmer felt the stabbing fear. She really hoped he wasn't talking about-

"Your pathetic rescue crew." Horde Prime smiled as he raised his hands, bringing out a very large tv-like screen. Glimmer could only watch in horror as she saw… well, herself, beat up Catra with harsh and strong movements.

"You… you bastard." Glimmer grit out angrily, watching as Clones charged at a handcuffed Bow and Adora. *How dare this bastard hurt my friends!*

"Me? Bastard?" Horde Prime smirked. **"I did nothing to your… *precious* friends. That, was *all you*."**

Glimmer glared at Horde Prime. "Do you really think I'll fall for your.. *edited fake* memories?"

"Why would I lie to you? Have I shown you anything false before?" Horde Prime shrugged, an evil smirk dancing on his lips.

"N- no…" Glimmer's heart broke, turning her head to stare at the screen in horror. "n- n.. no…"

She could *feel* his smirk as Horde Prime watched her fall apart. Having access to her mind meant he knew *exactly* how to cause Glimmer *pain* .

"You… You bastard."

"Had you not acted so *impulsively* , then maybe this could've never happened." Horde Prime tsked.

Glimmer glared at him. Using her anger to hide her pain, but he saw through her mask. He always did.

"Come on, *Queen* , I want to see you cry. Beg at me feet. You've held strong for long enough, aren't you tired?" Horde Prime hummed, pacing around Glimmer just outside her reach. **"Don't you just want to take a break from this... torture? You know, I could end it all. You would only be floating in the Abyss. No more pain, no more agony."**

Glimmer glowered at Horde Prime, but she felt a strange… sensation. Like… chains being loosened. "Fuck yourself."

Horde Prime sneered. **"I expected that answer. Another round of nightmares then?"**

Glimmer jerked in response, fear, agony, maybe. She didn't want to see those… nightmares he created as the worst possible situations. The Horde winning, Bow dying, Adora and everyone she knew hating Glimmer, Catra in place of Glimmer, Glimmer being unable to save Catra. "N- no."

“What was that Queen? I couldn’t hear you.”

Gritting her teeth, Glimmer called on the strength she still had. “No!” She spat, yanking herself forwards and finally, finally, she was able to hit him.

Those chains she felt loosing helped her now, letting her just barely reach that fucker that was Horde Prime.

Glimmer wanted *blood* . One could only take so much until they *snapped* . She wanted *blood* . Feeling Horde Prime’s weak skin under her fists brought joy as she punched him firmly in the face.

Horde Prime jerked back in shock, unable to escape as Glimmer dragged him into range again, pinning him under her as she brought her fists down at him. The chains painfully wrapped around her limbs as he watched Horde Prime struggle under her.

“No one.” punch.
“Hurts.” crack.

“My.” clsh.

“Friends!” Glimmer threw her hands down, shoving Horde Prime under her as she threw her weight down at him.

Satisfying cracks and noises as Glimmer basically beat Horde Prime was music to her ears.

“Fuck you!” Glimmer snarled, bringing her hands up and freezing at the blood staining her fingers.

She’s never *truly* killed someone. Only using her magic to stun people or just happen to *make* them fall to their death.

Yet here she was with blood staining her fingers.

Behind her, she could hear her own voice mocking Catra as sounds of fighting was behind her.

“Come one *Queen* .” Horde Prime sneered under her, strangely green blood dripping from his head as she sneered at Glimmer. **“Finish the job. Become the murderer you always *feared* .”**

Glimmer growled, dropping her hands. “Fuck you.”

“You always say that, but you don’t have the courage to follow through. So pathetic *Queen* . I would’ve thought you would be more. A *Queen* is supposed to be strong, unlike *you* .” Horde Prime mocked from under Glimmer.

“Shut. Up.” Glimmer shoved her hands on his throat, not choking him, but certainly making it more difficult to breathe.

Horde Prime laughed, a strained, chuckle that sounded horrible to Glimmer’s ears.

“Shut! UP!” Glimmer snarled, pushing Horde Prime into the void below them.

Then, the strangest thing happened. Horde Prime *glitched* .

Staticity, red and blue particles smeared together as he sounded more akin to like he was melting. Glimmer jumped away from him, horror dawning her features as she watched him still laughing despite becoming glitchy.

“You’re mad.” Glimmer muttered as she watched Horde Prime, the worst and most despicable creature Glimmer has ever met, slowly break apart into small, green bugs.

The bugs paused, seeing Glimmer, and lunged. Glimmer, however, lowered herself, preparing for the pain they would inflict.

Nothing happened.

She opened her eyes as she watched the glowing green tinted screens of those pesty bugs on Etheria fizzle away into nothing. Those small bugs cracking apart just as they got near her. Large,

glowing green cracks spread out from the black void, leaving behind large gash scars that spread outwards.

Glimmer yelped as a chunk of… void? slipped past her, leaving behind half of the chain she had always been straining against. She raised her hand to stare wordlessly at her now free hand, watching as the green chain fell away into particles.

Then, she threw her hand back, clawing at her neck where she knew another one of those… bugs would be. As soon as the chain on her left side crumbled away, she used that hand as well to pull it away.

Was Glimmer screaming or was that just the voice trapped inside of her head? Was this her or was that *him* ?

She *yanked* , boiling, spiking hot *pain* coursing through her body as she held the squirming tech bug between her hands.

"Fuck. You." Glimmer growled, her voice laced with pain as she watched her own blood drip off of the pests jaws like a steady stream.

She tore it into two, and finally, the voice was gone.

She woke up *screaming.*

***

Now when Entrapta says she wants to… 'experiment', usually that means something bad was about to happen.

But honestly? Bow trusted her not to hurt Glimmer as Entrapta flipped the girl on her back.

(Bow couldn't help but notice how weak she looked, malnourished and her beautiful hair was cut… Leaving behind bloody scars that complimented new burns and injuries on her body that just fueled Bow's rage.)

Now, it was going well. Entrapta had been taking apart the hexagon thing which seemed somewhat like a bug. It's jaws latched onto where her brain cord would be, glowing green bands spread across her veins like corruption.

Entrapta, thankfully, was doing her best to not hurt glimmer, yet also preserve as much as the bug as she could.

It wasn't until she had gotten to the bare minimum that the bug started screeching. A painful, high pitched angry squishing noise. Wiggling as it made it harder for Entrapta to take it apart further.

"Bow."

Bow took that moment, stepping forward and shoving his hand (gently) down to hold the bug in place. His thumbs rubbing gentle circles around the aggravated skin on Glimmer's neck.

Its okay Glimmer. We're here to save you. Please hold on.. Bow thought as he watched Entrapta work on the bug.

She grabbed a hold of it, yanking a tank that spilled the green fluid onto the floor as she set it aside.

By now, the bug was writhing, in what, pain? Bow wasn't sure.

Entrapta wrapped her hand around the bug, holding it firmly as she grabbed the main body and yanked it, tearing Glimmer's skin as Entrapta apologized to the pink haired queen.

The bug squirmed in Entrapta's grasp, and Bow started to move his hands off Glimmer when she *jerked* underneath Bow's hands.

Instinctively, Bo's hands pressed firmly against Glimmer's shoulders. Having dealt with her abruptly waking up at night.

Holding her gently in place, Bow watched as Glimmer *screamed* under him. A painful sound that Bow instinctively knew would haunt his nightmares.

Her scream of agony brough sounds of running footsteps as Catra and Adora crashed into the room, having been in another room for their 'secret talk', only to see Bow holding down a screaming and thrashing Glimmer.

"Glimmer! It's okay! Calm down!" Bow exclaimed as he rested his hands sprayed out on her back. "Its okay."

He rubbed gentle circles into the torn white robes on her back as Glimmer twisted under his grip.

"Glimmer!"
"Sparkles!"

Two more hands moved to hold down Glimmer's legs and torso as Catra and Adora joined the group. Gentle (or not so gentle in Catra's case) hands moving to hold Glimmer down from hurting herself or anyone else.

"Sparkles, you aren't there anymore!" Catra said, her voice taking on a strangely desperate tone that Bow had never heard from her before.

"Glimmer! Calm down!" Adora pleaded Glimmer, her hands keeping Glimmer's legs from kicking.

Bow leaned in, putting a gentle hand on Glimmer's neck. Instantly Glimmer stilled, and Bow leaned to talk to Glimmer quietly. "Glim, its okay. You're okay, calm down. You're out of that place."

Glimmer, who had been screaming incoherent words, whimpered, her eyes squeezed shut as she made small pitiful sounds of pain. "They… Etheria… More in the.. Hive…" She muttered before her head lolled to the side, her eyes slipping shut as he fell unconicious.

Gently, Adora and Catra let their hands go as Bow gently took bandage wrap and wrapped it around Glimmer's neck, making sure to stop the bleeding from the stupid bug before he propped Glimmer up, gently setting her to lay on her back more comfortably on the pillows.

(Bow couldn't help but worry about how light she was, but at the same time, that anger Bow had felt towards Glimmer for being impulsive also started to fizzle away, not completely, but… somewhat.)

Glimmer made a small noise of protest as Bow stepped back. Eagerly burrowing under the thin blankets that Bow put over her.

Bow let out a breath he didn't even know he was holding, and turned to look at Adora and Catra. Now that he studied them, he noticed the lack of tension they had before. Plus, Catra looked like she had just come out of the shower, her hair dripping wet as her clothing was hastily thrown on.

"I'm sorry Bow.." Adora stared at Glimmer sadly.

Bow sighed, his hands hanging by his sides. "I'm just glad she's alive and okay." Bow confessed.

Catra took a step forward, tilting her head at Glimmer. Bow shook his head. He still felt angry at Glimmer, despite… whatever she had to go through.

(Bow was pretty sure that Glimmer learned her lesson but… she could be stubborn like that… but- Bow hoped she didn't change so much while under Horde Prime's control.)

Bow rubbed his brow as Catra stared at Glimmer sadly. Taking a few steps forward, Catra gently brushed Glimmer's bangs to the side. "Oh Sparkles. I'm so sorry for what you had to go through."

Bow sighed, dejected and sad. "I'm…" Bow paused, unsure what he could do. Anything that he could do to get rid of the nightmare that just happened.

“Speaking of which, where is Entrapta?” Adora blinked in surprise.

“She passed us on the way out. Talking about how she wasn’t good with people and wanted to study the thing in Glimmer’s neck.” Catra gestured towards the door.

***

“Fascinating, they took the energy of the bug to put into a persons bloodstream in order to connect them to a higher network of specially accessible information that is regulated by Horde Prime!”
“Smaller words please? What was that about our lord and savior Horde Prime?”

***

Bow rubbed his nose. “Sounds accurate.”

He let out a deep sigh through his nose. “Hey, wait-”

Bow paused, as he was about to leave, turning to Catra. “How are you feeling Catra?”

Catra blinked. “Why is everyone worried about me when Sparkles has probably experienced hell?!”

“Because… those words that not-Glimmer spoke,”

“The Queen as Horde Prime referred to her.” Catra said darkly.

“They weren’t her own. We can all agree on that right?” Nods of agreement. “But, what she said is based off of Glimmer’s own…

feelings, warped and manipulated by Horde Prime to be.. worse, I assume." Bow rubbed his arms.

"You're lucky that you didn't get the as harsh words." Catra muttered by Bow heard her.

"I think, we're in need of a talk." Bow sighed, his shoulders falling slightly. "Let me get some chairs."

Bow took his leave, taking out the folded up chairs and setting them out for the group from where they could watch over Glimmer.

Sitting down in the (moderately) uncomfortable chairs, resting his folded hands on his lap at he glanced Glimmer mostly on instinct.

"Oh, its like the therapy sessions we did with the resistance!" Adora realized outloud.

"... You've been getting thearpy?" Catra's eyebrows furrowed as she took a seat.

Silence.

"So, Catra you're getting therapy when we get home." Bow mumbled rubbing his temple.

Catra rolled her eyes. "Well, what are we talking about first?"

Adora shared a glance with Bow. "We want to start with… uh, me..?"

Catra turned to stare at Adora quietly. Bow followed suit, watching intently.

"Uh- oh thats bad. No, no, stop." Adora adverted her eyes from the duo watching her.

"..." Bow glanced at Catra and shrugged, staring at the floor silently.

"I- I'm worried. About Glimmer, about home… about Catra and you Bow." Adora admitted after a minute of silence. "I'm most of all, worried about the future. What if, I can't become She-Ra again? What if, She-Ra only triggers in dangerous situations? I don't want that to happen to you just for me to… transform."

Bow frowned, leaning forwards.

"Catra, Catra's changed. I'm glad to have her back… but at the same time, I don't- I want to trust her but… I can't, not yet." Adora continued. "I forgave her, but… I can't trust her. Not yet. That bond we had before the war, well, it'll take time to regain."

Catra made a humming noise of agreement.

Silence settled over the group.

"Is that..?"

"YUP!" Adora yelped, having ahd sat there with her face stready growing hot as she shook her head. Her hair whacking her in the face.

"Do we hae to say… everything?" Catra spoke up worriedly.

"No, no. Of course not. Only what you want to share." Bow waved his hands in front of him as he turned to look at Catra.

Catra took a deep breath. "I think you deserve to know what… *exactly* happened in that ship. Sparkles.. she was a prisoner while I was… a guest." Catra spat out the word like it burned her tongue. "She was treated… differently, harshly. While I was able to relish in the luxuries."

Catra stared at the ground silently. "He… he tortured her. I couldn't do anything when I should've done it… I..The only thing I did was sit by her door to just. *Talk* about nothing. I couldn't even distract her… Sometimes I slept with her, I always noticed she disliked being alone." Catra admitted quietly. "But, she was hurting and the most I could do was… offer useless words."

“Catra-”

“What she said about me being a horrible person is right. I shouldn’t expect forgiveness. Expecially from all of you. I’m a weak, pathetic person who could do *nothing* , while Sparkles over there fought back against him.” Catra cut Adora off. “She had to go through so much. When she sent me… the orginal plan was I was going to send her over. But- she saw through my plan and.. tricked me, throwing me into the teleporter and sneding me off. I was supposed to be the one to be left behind, because no one would even go after me anyways.”

“Not true.” Adora blurted out. “I would come after you.”

“And Glimmer would also if what you said is true. She doesn’t trust easily, but if she let you close, well, you’re not going to get away easily.” Bow agreed. “You underestimate our selflessness.”

Catra frowned. “But you shouldn’t. I mean, you shouldn’t go after me.”

“Catra, let me say this in the nicest way possible. We care about you.” Bow started, gesturing to himself and Adora. “I may not have known you as long as Adora, or have seen your soft side that Adora talks about. But if this trip has shown me anything, we would’ve still come after you. We would’ve still become friends.”

Catra stared at the floor.

“Bow is right. We won’t just leave you there on that nightmare ship.” Adora nodded. “I won’t let it!”

Bow chuckled. “I’m sure Glimmer would agree with us.”

Shooting a glance at the sleeping Glimmer, Bow turned back to Catra. “The first step to the future is learning how to love yourself.”

Catra winced staring at the floor. “...”

“Uhm. Should I start?” Bow asked as Catra stayed silent staring at the ground.

“Maybe yeah.” Adora agreed.

Where to start…

Bow took a deep breath. “I’m, also worried. About Glim, about you, about Etheria, about… my dads.”

Rubbing his arms he took a deep breath. “I have… so many emotions inside of me just… thinking.”

“Start out with what’s easier.” Adora suggested, Catra remained silent but glanced up at Bow.

“My… dads. Are they okay? Is Etheria okay? I’m sure if it wasn’t, obviously Horde Prime would love to rub it into our faces but… What are they having to deal with?” Bow worried outloud. “And, and BrightMoon, are they okay? Are they all dead or-”

Bow took a deep breath. “I hate not knowing what’s going on back home.”

Adora made a noise of agreement. “It does suck.”

Catra stayed silent, but definitely had a pondering and thoughtful look on her face.

“Next… The people on this ship. Catra, Adora, you are both so… tense. I know your past is, harsh between you two, but we’re a team. Teams, they work together. They get along. I only want, that you two to get along. To be able to regain your trust between yourselves. I know that, trust is hard, but, man.” Bow shook his head. “Entrapta and Wrong Hordak, not sure what to think about Wrong Hordak, I feel like he’s going to keep all of us on edge but.. Entrapta, she’s distractable, I worry about her saftey, despite her being so much smarter than me.”

Adora looked like she wanted to protest but Bow held his hand up to stop her. “Glimmer.”

Where to start with Glimmer? He was angry but, he still loved her.

Oh. He loved her.

“I’m… upset at Horde Prime for what he did to her.” Bow started. “But, at the same time. I’m still kind of upset at Glimmer for… well, opening the portal. I know that, she wasn’t the one who *brought* Horde Prime to our home, but… I’m just upset she didn’t, even tell me her plan.” Bow’s shoulders sagged.

“Yet at the same time, I’m grateful that she is alive…” Bow turned to stare at Glimmer silently, lovingly maybe even. “I just wish that no one needed to experience.”

Bow sighed. “I just… I don’t know. I want to be mad, but I think she learned her mistake too harshly. I want to be supportive, but I don’t know how I should do it. She doesn’t like people watching over her.”

Bow remained silent, as his gaze remained at Glimmer.

“Bow-” Adora started, snapping Bow out of his trance. “I’m sure she understands if you were to be mad or not. I think what she needs most is, well, support. We don’t even know the tip of what she went through.”

Catra made a noise of agreement.

Bow sighed, gently touching Glimmer’s hair and brushing the tangles mess to the side. Despite it being unbrushed, unkempt, and greasy, it was still so beautiful.

She was beautiful.

(He would wait by her side until she woke up.)

Chapter End Notes

Hey! How are you guys?
We've had a good week of motivation hitting me back!
Oh! Also, BREAK TIME! Get water, a snack, and stretch! It's important!

Catra: What is Entrapta doing?
Bow: Her best.

Glimmer: Your Honor, I hereby submit the following to the court:
Glimmer: 'Horde Prime, what the actual FUCK?'

Returning Home

Chapter Summary

Glimmer wakes up to a friendly surprise!

Bow is having a rough time.
Entrapta ponders and mourns on what she learned.
Adora finds help in the strangest of places.
And Glimmer learns that wounds take time to heal.

Chapter Notes

Woooo! Final of this, IG, book?
LOL
ENJOY IT (ITS HERE OH GOD DON'T FREAK OUT YALL-!)

Okay, so enjoy it!
And don't forget to hydrate and don't diedrate!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Glimmer made a noise of protest as a gentle hand brushed through her hair, and her eyelids felt heavy. She just wanted to go back to sleep.

(Green eyes. Bugs. Wake up.)

But, that annoyingly bright light above her kept flashing.

(Wake up. Wake up. WAKE UP.)

Reluctantly, Glimmer pulled herself from the sweet comfort of sleep.

(She slept forever. Why was she still so tired?)

"Five more minutes.." Glimmer muttered, weakly swatting the hand away. She couldn't help but noticed that it had paused at her voice.

The voices which had been soothing became dead silent.

Her eyelids fluttered open and she stared blankly at two blurry shapes which, upon seeing her open eyes, jumped up. Voices mashing together into a cacophony of noise as they huddled around her.

"-mmer!"
"Sparkles!"

Slowly, (too slowly) shapes came into view. Forming familiar faces and familiar expressions of worry.

"Hu- huh..?" Glimmer moved her hand to her neck where she felt *something* rubbing against her skin. A bandage wrap? What?

"Glimmer! Are you okay?" Bow worried, holding up Glimmer's hands and carefully checking them over.

"What… Catra?!" Glimmer sat upright at seeing the cat women who awkwardly waved at Glimmer.

"Hey Sparkles."

Glancing around, Glimmer frowned at the unfailiar yet also familiar enviroment. "Where…"

Then, it hit her. Horde Prime, Catra, the fight.

Glimmer instinctively curled in on herself. Fighting back the sob that bubbled in her throat dangeriously close to spilling from her lips. "N- no.." She muttered in horror.

She jerked away from Bow's touch, flinching in on herself. "No- get away. Get away- please- I'm going to hurt you-"

"Sparkles." Catra's voice was oddly calm and sympathetic. "Calm down. You aren't under his control anymore. We destroyed the thing in your neck."

That explained the bandages around her neck. “I-... why…?”

“Huh?” Catra tilted her head, glancing at Bow.

“I tried- you weren’t supposed to come after me.. he wouldn’t, he wouldn’t kill me.. He needed me.” Glimmer mumbled shyly, brokenly.

(Bow could only watch, his heart breaking as he saw is best friend, the person he *loved* , sound so.. defeated, so, destroyed.)

“Because you matter.” Bow said confidently.

Catra nodded, though a bit hesitantly.

“Where-”

“Mara’s ship.” Bow supplied.

“Oh.” Glimmer made some whimpers as she moved, her muscles shrieking in protest.

(She was not the Queen- not the puppet that he had made her be.)

“Etheria!” Glimmer exclaimed, recalling those tv screens. “We need to-”

“Sparkles wait-!” Catra exclaimed, just seconds before Glimmer recoiled and fell over the bed.

Thankfully, strong, *warm* , arms wrapped around her. (She forgot what it was like to be hugged.. how long had she been in that ship? It felt like… forever.)

Glancing up, Glimmer met the face of Bow.

(Oh fuck he’s hotter than Glimmer remembered. God fucking dangit Glimmer! Shove them down again. We don’t have time for you to get lost in love!)

Unfortunately, Glimmer couldn't do much but stare at Bow as Bow gently set Glimmer onto the bed.

"Be careful." His voice was gruff, oh my fucking lord did Glimmer miss hearing his voice. (Shut up brain!)

"I- uh-" Goddamit Glimmer stuttered like a stupid kid. She swallowed, her broken fingernails digging into her arm as she ground herself. "I'm… Fine."

"No, no. Rewind, try again." Bow said sternly, moving a chair to sit right in Glimmer's face with determination in his gaze.

"I'm.. fin-"

"No."

"I'm serious t-"

"Glimmer."

"But I a-"

"Glim. No."

Glimmer glanced away, being unable to win the stare battles she used to win by her pure stubbornness. "I am.. not okay."

"See? Wasn't hard." Bow gestured to Catra. "Took Catra a few days to say that."

Catra glared halfheartedly at Bow. "Not true."

"Definitely true. Adora had to drag it out of you." Bow sighed.

"Adora is here?" Glimmer stuttered, fear racking her senses. (Why weren't they upset at her? They should be! She was the one that summoned Horde Prime and started the end of the world anyways!)

(She was the Queen- she let herself become that… *monster* .)

“Yeah along with Entrapta and… oh wait.” Catra shot up. “Arrow Boy, I’m going to make sure Entrapta’s new friend doesn’t come near here. Sparkles isn’t in a good mental state to see… him.”

“Who?”

“Good idea Catra.”

“Who?!”

“I’ll also tell Adora about Sparkles waking up so then she can help keep him away from Sparkles.”

“WHO?!” Glimmer nearly shouted, she really wanted to pull her hair. (She didn’t. It was too short- wait, why is it so short? Was it this short before??)

“Uh, Wrong Hordak.” Catra looked nervious.

‘Hordak. Hordak. Hordak. Wrong Hordak?’ Glimmer felt her stomach drop. The person who shared a face with someone she just tried to murder in her own mind.

“N- no thank you.. Wh- why is..”

“Entrapta.” Both Bow and Catra said as if it explained everything.

“He’s also been removed from the hivemind like you.” Bow added helpfully.

Glimmer watched a Catra darted out of the room.

(Catra staring at Adora with green eyes. Catra laughing in the same tone she had in that video. Catra… Catra being friends with… everyone. Catra saving her from that nightmare.)

Glimmer and Bow sat in silence.

(Was it comfortable? Glimmer wasn’t sure. It’s been a while since she’s been with someone other than Horde Prime.)

“Bow-”

“Glimmer-”

Both of them burst into laughter. (When was the last time Glimmer laughed with Bow?)

“You go.”

“No, you can.”

Silence as the two snicker, before Glimmer’s face fell. “Then… I’ll go.”

Bow’s expression turned serious.

“Why aren’t you.. no wait, you are mad at me, aren’t you? I mean- I was the one who brought Horde Prime to Etheria-”

“Glimmer no.” Bow narrowed his gaze. His hands moving to cup around Glimmer’s shaking palms. “I mean, yeah I am. But not because of that. Because you didn’t *talk* to us, Adora or me.”

Glimmer’s gaze landed on a wall on the far side. “Oh. I thought-”

“Well you thought wrong, princess.” Catra spoke up from the doorway, stalking in with Adora at her heels. Adora spotted Glimmer sitting and ran over.

“Glimmer! Are you okay? Are you well?”

Glimmer stifled a laugh. Sharing a look with Catra.

(They both had such worrying friends… Both of them fell in love with such worrywarts.)

“I’m-” A glare from Bow. “Better than I was before.” Glimmer corrected herself.

Adora stood at arms length, staring at Glimmer before her hands moved, gently hitting Glimmers cheek. Glimmer blinked in shock

at the quick, yet very painless compared to past experiences, before Adora hugged her.

“Adora-?”

“You worried us!” Adora shouted. “How dare you think we wouldn’t come after you. You- you- grrr.”

Glimmer blinked, glancing at Catra in confusion who smiled knowingly. “I’m not going to help you here, Sparkles. Everyone’s been worried about you.”

Glimmer sighed, smiling softly at the hug. “I- I missed you too Adora. And Bow, and Catra.”

Catra let out a short bark of laughter.

Then, Glimmer remembered something. That fur tuff, did she-?

Adora pulled away, moving to stand by Catra. (That annoying tension was still there. Gosh dangit Glimmer would have to shove the two of them into a closet she swore to the Old Ones. But- they seemed more comfortable around each other. That’s a start.)

Glimmer brought her hands to her robes, freezing as she glared at the robes. They were disgusting, absolutely no pink on them whatsoever. But in her rare free moments of herself, she was allowed to wear her own clothing under the disgusting robes. Something about how that would make Glimmer ‘more nostalgic or something stupid like that’. But, thankfully her outfit had pockets. Shoving her hand inside one of the pockets, she involuntarily gasped in surprise at feeling the soft sensation under her fingers.

She brought it out, studying the tuff ball carefullly between her fingertips.

“Wait isn’t that-” Catra startled at seeing the fur.

Glimmer jumped, having forgotten about her friends in the room. “Uh- n- no!”

She hurriedly moved to put it away but was stopped by Catra. “Sparkles. That’s my fur, isn’t it?”

“Uh-” Glimmer glanced at Bow and Adora desperately as if searching for a lifeboat. “Maayybeee?”

“Sparkles.”

“Ugh! Fine! Yeah it is! It was… lonely…” Glimmer glanced at the fur, tucking it carefully to her chest. “Besides, it's fluffy and has an actual… sensation.”

Catra stared at her, as if she was unsure how to react. “Oh uh- I didn’t-”

Adora and Bow looked at each other sadly, Glimmer knew she looked like a sad sack but- it helped her!

Glimmer kept her hands cupped around the fur. “It helped.”

Catra stared at her, moving to sit on the bed. “Hey.. Sparkles? Could I say something before you talk to everyone else?”

Glimmer glanced at Catra curiously.

“I’m… sorry about what I did. And-”

“Oh I know. I forgave you the moment I realized what you were doing, using that teleporter.” Glimmer waved Catra off casually.

“I’m- I’m sorry, what?” Catra was caught off guard.

Glimmer smiled sadly. “I had… a lot of time to think and… I realized something Catra. You and I, we’re very similar. I- I probably would’ve done the things you did to be honest.”

Catra stared at Glimmer silently. “O- oh.”

“But uh, before you go. I wanted to… thank you.” Glimmer admitted shyly.

(Woah she’s changed. Adora thought in surprise. She’s grown… mature! But its a.. sad mature. Like someone who grew up too fast. But then again, isn’t that all of us?)

“For what?”

“For, the talks.. The- moments on that… that place.” Glimmer shuddered involuntarily as she thought about her prison cell.

“Oh.” Catra’s hands hovered around Glimmer carefully. “Uh- thank you for… not kicking me out?”

“Not like I could anyways.” Glimmer said, her voice lacking amusement as she thought about it.

“Oh..”

“Nor did I want to!” Glimmer blurted out, waving her hands frantically.

Catra stood up abruptly. Letting out a quiet sob. “God fucking dammit Sparkles! You weren’t supposed to be left behind!”

Glimmer paused at seeing Catra glare at her sadly. “You weren’t-”

Catra hugged Glimmer, her hands were awkwardly bent as Glimmer still cradled the tuft of fur as Catra broke down into small sobs.

“Uh-” Glimmer glanced at Adora, pleading her to get her friend (cough cough, GIRLFRIEND, cough cough) off.

Adora, however, only smiled at Glimmer’s predicament. “Glimmer, listen here. That wasn’t *your* fault! I know you probably feel guilty for hurting Catra and summoning Horde Prime and stuff, but that wasn’t you-”

“Huh…? I know the… control one wasn’t- but… those were my emotions.. As for the summoning- I did…”

“That Horde Prime *manipulated* !” Adora exclaimed. “And also no, Horde Prime apparently has been tracking us since the whole, alternative timeline-portal mess.”

Glimmer frowned, unconvinced.

Adora sniffed. “Sc- scoot over Catra.”

Adora gently shoved Catra, who splayed on Glimmers bed as Adora threw herself into the bed as well, joining Catra in huddling together and sobbing.

“Fucking- what the fuck is happening?!” Glimmer turned to Bow, who was already sobbing. Already having had hugged Glimmer who’s eyebrows furrowed in confusion at the hug. “Uh- what is happening?!”

“Oh hi Glimmer! I’m glad to see you awake!” Entrapta poked her head in, her purple hair moving in a wave as Glimmer glanced up at Entrapta in confusion.

“Wha-” Glimmer froze at seeing Green eyes behind Entrapta before Glimmer yelped as Catra’s tail flicked over her eyes.

“Catra-! Get your tail out of my face!” Glimmer exclaimed, shoving the tail away. (Glancing at the door showed that both Entrapta and the other… guest gone from view.)

“Seriously guys, get off me-” Glimmer grumbled with no real anger, gently pushing Adora who’s sobs have turned into giggles.

Glimmer couldn’t help it, breaking down into her own giggles.

Bow, still having his legs and bottom half of his body in the chair, had bent forward to shove his face, laughing, into Glimmer’s shoulder. But now he pulled back, smiling softly at Glimmer.

“I- Glimmer, promise me something would you?” Bow asked, wiping the tears on his face.

“Uh- sure.” Glimmer sat up, Adora’s shoulder stated to shake less as Catra’s mismatched eyes watched the two from her sadden look.

“Please, please don’t do something like this again.” Bow reached forwards, forcing Glimmer to tuck the piece of fur away.

“...” Glimmer stared at Bow as he took her hands. “Okay.. I- I won’t.” *Mom* . Glimmer wanted to say so badly, but that just brought back more bouts of trauma.

(Man she would have a lot of trauma after this, all of them would…)

“You promise?”

“Best Friend Squad promise.” Glimmer agreed quietly.

“ *Cough cough* , Lovebirds, *cough cough* .” Catra coughed behind Glimmer. Glimmer’s face burned as she glared at Catra.

“You don’t get to say *anything* , Catra.” Glimmer pointed at Catra with her pointer finger.

Catra sputtered, causing Adora and Bow to laugh. (They both looked a big red, Adora Glimmer would know why, Bow… Was it Catra’s comment? No heart, don’t start fluttering. STOP-)

Glimmer laughed smiling sadly at the ceiling.

***

Glimmer could barely walk after her.. well, unfortunate situation.

Bow was honestly worried.

Thankfully, or not depending on how you looked a it, Bow couldn't really be in the same room with her for long. Since he was one of the only two people on the ship who knew how to make the ship function properly.

So, unfortunately, Bow wasn't around when Glimmer met Wrong Hordak.

But from what Adora told him, a lot of unhinged screeching. Thankfully, Bow had come by later in turn, peeking his head inside the room curiously.

"Hey Glim? You here?" Bow's eyes flickered across the darkness intent on finding the pink mass that was Glimmer.

A grumbled protest is heard and Bow chuckled lightly.

"I'll take that as a yes."

Bow couldn't help but laugh quietly as he saw movement in Glimmer's bed, her pink eyes glinting in the dark as she glared at him. His laughter died in this throat at her blank, dull stare.

"Hey, you okay?" Bow strolled over, peering down at Glimmer.

"No." Glimmer admitted, her voice muffled as her face was pressed into her pillow.

Bow frowned. "What happened?"

Glimmer stared at him for a solid minute, her eyes flicking across his face. Bow couldn't help the heat that burned his face, he hoped desperately that the darkness of the room hid it.

"Wrong Hordak." Glimmer finally muttered out, her eyes moving to stare at the floor in a dazed kind of way.

Oh. Oh no. “Oh.” Bow startled out loud, he crouched over to peer at Glimmer. “Oh.”

Glimmer glared halfheartedly from under her blanket, her pretty pink eyes glittering as she glared at him.

Bow glanced around the room, moving to bring a chair closer but was stopped by Glimmer who had a deathgrip on his wrist.

“Don’t, leave.” Glimmer murmered, her eyes looking sad and broken than usual.

Bow froze at her (usually) strong grip which was weak now. “Okay.”

Bow instead moved, moving to sit on the floor when he was yanked forwards and collided with something warm.

“Ack!” Bow yelped as he felt Glimmer’s arms grip his, looping between his arms as she was trembling.

“M’sorry.” Glimmer apologized, no at all feeling remorseful.

Bow laughed, his hand instinctively moving to brush the pink hair from Glimmer’s face. “It’s okay Glim.”

(Was he still mad? No. Frustrated? Maybe.)

Bow hugged Glimmer, and it felt like coming home.

“Do you want to talk about… your encounter?” Bow asked after a minute of silence.

Glimmer started talking, stumbling at first before she powered on slowly.

All Bow could think was that they all got the short end of the sticks.

***

Ever since Glimmer had woken up again, the entire mood of the ship has been, overall, brighter.

Even Entrapta could see that.

Well no, expecially Entrapta could see that.

She wasn't exactly sure how to deal with the mix of emotions swirling around her gut, coiling like a spring as she busied herself with working on the ship. The calming actions of absentmindedly working with mechinics, crafting and weaving into a wonderful display for Darla.

Wrong Hordak had been helpful, however, it's clear that the group doesn't seem to like him very much, or at least they avoid him. Entrapta may be distracted often, but even she could see how much they avoided Wrong Hordak.

(Was it a mistake to bring him along…? No- no. Was it…?)

Shaking her head, she returned to the dull task of weaving a pair of wires together easily, watching as the sparks flickered in the darkness. Providing a quick distraction from Entrapta's raging mind.

She sighed, flicking her wrist as she stuck her tongue out in determination. She yanked upwards, smiling in satisfaction at the click symbolizing it was in place.

Wiping her brow, she flicked through the wires, picking them apart as she was laid under the console.

"Hey Entrapta." Bow greeted, Entrapta heard his steps stop nearby. Probably to study the console on top.

“Heya Bow!” Entrapta said, sputtering a bit as some oil spit in her face as her hands made rapid movements.

Bow remained silent, the only noise in the room was the sounds of wires sparking and mechanical parts clicking together as Entrapta worked on the underneath.

“How are you holding up?” Bow asked suddenly, startling Entrapta who narrowly missed banging her head on the console in surprise.

“Me? I am doing great! The technology here could keep me entertained for hours!” Entrapta cheered, her mind brought back the mess of emotions that swung in her chest. *You’re avoiding your problems.* Her mind whispered.

Entrapta might’ve shoved a wire into a socket a *bit* too hard.

“I didn’t mean that Entrapta.” Bow said. Had Entrapta seen his face, he was probably frowning that disappointment frown.

“Then what did you mean?” Entrapta held a wire in a death grip as she stayed under the console, fiddling with the wires underneath with practiced ease.

“I mean. How are you mentally? Emotionly?” Bow said after a moment.

Entrapta pushed herself away from the underside of the console, shutting the compartment door as she slid out. New oil stained her face and clothing as she met Bow’s eyes.

“...” Entrapta glanced behind Bow where Wrong Hordak was pointing a hologram of a cat curiously.

Bow turned around, seeing Wrong Hordak and then turned back to her. “You miss him, don’t you?”

Entrapta remained silent, but she knew her face had fallen confirming it.

Bow hummed, sitting on the floor. “Tell me about him.”

Entrapta regarded Bow in surprise. “You want me… to talk about- But, I shouldn’t. You are still dealing with your companion still injured.” Entrapta blurted out.

Bow sighed. “I think I’ve realized something, Entrapta. Something we share in common. We both try to distract ourselves from pain.”

Entrapta frowned, studying Bow with her analytical eyes. “... I see.”

Bow sighed, rubbing his knee where he sat down. “So can I ask again, how are you holding up?”

“Not good.” Entrapta sighed, her shoulders dropping. “The tension within the ship has reached a level of such capacity, it has affected the general mood of the group to lower the inability to function efficiently.”

Bow nodded, having to take a moment to process her words before humming in understanding. “I see.” Bow sighed, his shoulders slumping a bit.

Entrapta fell silent, rubbing her cheek and smearing the oil from her hands onto her face. “He isn’t Hordak.”

“Huh?” Bow blinked, turning to glance at her.

“Wrong Hordak isn’t Hordak. He’s just a clone.”

Bow’s eyes stayed on Entrapta, and Entrapta shuddered at the intensity of them. Looking at him, she noticed a strange emotion in Bow’s eyes. Sadness and… something else.

“I am sorry Entrapta.” Bow said, and that’s when the mystery emotion clicked. It was pity.

Entrapta’s shoulders slumped, but she remained silent.

"You shouldn't care about that, you need to focus on yourself." Entrapta sighed, rubbing her arms absentmindedly.

Bow shook his head, a gentle hand moving to stop Entrapta's own moving hand and stilling it. "Sometimes, you need to focus on many. We are a team, Entrapta. What's your problem is just as important as mine." Bow explained.

Entrapta met Bow's eyes, her hand dropping to the floor. "I… understand."

Humans are difficult to understand , Entrapta notes, *but she was willing to try.*

***

Catra hasn't done much in the last few days. Being only able to pace around and wallow in her guilt.

She wasn't friends with them, why did they insist on Catra resting?

Oh how much Catra wanted to just *do* something. It was like a burning urge that swam in her guts and burned her very core.

But, unlike Arrow Boy or Entrapta, Catra had no knowledge on how the ship worked. And unlike Adora, she didn't have a magical princess warrior to try and focus on becoming again.

So she only really found solace in Glimmer, the only other person who is banned from doing anything aboard the ship.

"Hey Sparkles." Catra greeted as she sat cross legged on the end of Glimmer's bed.

"Hello Catra." Glimmer agreed, rubbing her eyes.

“Not sleeping well pr- Sparkles?” Catra fumbled, almost falling into her old habits of calling Glimmer ‘princess’ or ‘queen’, but then she recalls… Horde Prime’s treatment.

Glimmer shook her head, a haunted look to her eyes.

Catra’s tail flicked. The two of them havenn’t talked about what happened on that ship, well… they touched on it when Glimmer first woke up, but they haven’t quite had a heart-to-heart yet.

But as the two made idle conversation, to desperately hide their hatred of being useless, it slipped into untalked territory.

Horde Prime.

It started simple enough.

“Do you think if I had succeeded in teleporting you onto this ship, our positions would have been switched?” Catra mumbled after a dull and comfortable lull in silence.

Instantly, the air was charged with tension, quiet and stabbing.

Then, Glimmer let out a small puff of air. “Yeah. He- one of his tatics was to tell me about if it had been the opposite way.” Glimmer mumbled quietly, her voice strained with emotions to thick to be held in her fragile body.

Catra sucked in a breath. “He would’ve-?”

Glimmer nodded, her eyes dark and hazy as if she was recalling a horrible memory.

Catra’s ears flicked in horror. “Oh fuu-” She didn’t finish as she pressed her hands against her mouth, as if the bile swimming in her throat would go away that easily.

Glimmer remained dead silent as Catra processed. Swallowing hard, Catra fought the bile in her throat.

“Although… I think it would’ve been better had it been m-” Catra startled as Glimmer shoved her hand over Catra’s mouth to shut her up.

“No. Shut. Catra, despite what you think about your own self worth, we wouldn’t just leave you! I know full well that Adora wouldn’t, and I wouldn’t. On that ship- you, you showed me you weren’t a pure evil as I always proclaimed you were.” Glimmer growled, her normally dull eyes flashing with color and determination. “And I sure as hell wouldn’t let you stay there.”

Catra held her tongue between her teeth, and when Glimmer didn’t move her hand, Catra proceeded to lick her palm.

“Ew-!” Glimmer shrieked as she yanked her hand away, her palm wet with Catra’s saliva.

“Yea, but why does showing that I’m not so evil really make such a big important deal Sparkles? I’m still your enemy! All of those acts were still commited, willingly, by me!” Catra’s hand had moved to rest on her chest as she spoke.

“Because-” Glimmer swallowed, taking a shallow breath. “We aren’t that different Catra. You, me? I would’ve done the same thing if Bow had left me alone in that, well, horrible enviroment. No offense.” Glimmer wiped her hand on Catra’s sleeves and Catra stuck her tongue out in response.

“None taken. It was a horrible place anyways.”

“But its still your home.” Glimmer pointed out, her hand moving to rest on her lap once she was done wiping the saliva off. “And besides, you weren’t the only one manipulated.”

Catra blinked, noting Glimmer’s shy glance at the wall. “You-?”

“Yeah.” Glimmer sighed melancholy, her eyes screwing shut.

Catra stayed silent for a while before laughing lightly and yet strained. “I didn’t think- Wow Sparkles, I guess we are more

similar than I first thought. We both suck at emotion time."

Glimmer let out a weak laugh, which brought a smile to Catra's face to see her smiling. (Weakly, but hopefully soon she would be able to smile without bounds.)

That's how Bow found the two of them. Curled up together like they were still on that ship.

Finding comfort in each other again.

***

Adora fumbled for what felt like the third time that very morning. Tripping over her feet as she focused a bit hard on trying to summone She-Ra. She crashed into the ground, letting out a small pained whimper as the cool ground greeted her.

"Are you okay?" A voice exclaimed, a very familiar and haunting voice. Jumping, Adora nearly collided with Wrong Hordak, and she ducked away from his gaze, tumbling back to the floor out of pure instinct of 'get away- get AWAY-' screaming through her bones.

"A- Ah! Wrong Hordak! Y- yes! I am fine!" Adora agreed cheerfully, moving to make it look like she was on the floor for a reason, crossing her arms and propping her head up to appear relaxed despite the horrible thumping of her heart that echoed in her ears.

Wrong Hordak frowned. "You seem… to be far more distracted. Has Horde Prime's glittering salvation showed its path to you?"

Adora winced, unsure how to tell Wrong Hordak the truth. "Uh-"

"True nourishment comes from the favor of Horde Prime." Wrong Hordak continued much to Adora's horror.

Adora groaned, standing up and covering half of her face with her left hand. She was, admittedly, unsure how to handle Wrong Hordak. Despite the name, just looking at him filled Adora with rage.

(How dare he hurt her friends. How dare he torture Glimmer and hurt Catra. *How dare he-*)

Taking a deep breath, Adora sighed through her mouth. The air pressing into the air of the ship. "It is… more complicated than that, Hor- I mean Wrong Hordak." Adora rubbed her nose.

"Then enlighten me, friend." Wrong Hordak leaned over to peer down at Adora as Adora winced.

"I am not sure you want that- it would probably be a bad thing to-"

"At least allow me to know what ails you before this time." Wrong Hordak said straightening his spine.

Adora's shoulders slumped inwards, making her appear smaller than she actually was. "I am.. trying to recreate something that happened on the ship."

"That golden glow?" Wrong Hordak tilted his head, his green eyes watching Adora's moves.

Adora scratched her arm, leaving red indents upon her skin. "Uh- yeah."

"Hmm." Wrong Hordak pondered. "Is it technology?"

"Erm- no."

"Personal powers?"

"Maybe..?"

"Inherited abilities?"

“Probably not.”

“Scientific to your species?”

“You’ve been hanging around Entrapta way too much.”

“That does not answer the question.”

“... no.”

Wrong Hordak rubbed his cheek in thought. “I then do not understand.”

“Magic, it’s magic.” Adora wiggled her fingers.

“Mag-ic?” Wrong Hordak frowned. “But everything can be explained by science. Horde Prime has shown that millions of times at every new world we civilize.”

Civilize? Is that what he believes what happens when they go and kill everyone on a planet? Adora gaped at Wrong Hordak, her eyes wide. “Do you really think- that they ‘civilize’ planets, by wiping out the entire population?”

Wrong Hordak blinked in surprise. “What?”

“They don’t ‘civilize’ the people. They kill them! They rule over an iron fist and take away all of the resources of the planet and leave them to die!” Adora nearly shouted, he hands coming to become fists by her side as she raised her blue eyes to stare at Wrong Hordak.

“I- I do not understand? He’s always said- He- lied?” Wrong Hordak blinked in shock, staring at his hands. “I- can this be proven?”

Adora frowned. “We might have some images we’ve taken.” Adora agreed, standing up and stalking into the cockpit. She threw herself onto the chair and flicked it on. Studying the room, Adora could see Entrapta’s feet as she worked on the consoles.

Adora flicked across the screen as she felt the looming presence of Wrong Hordak behind her. Snapping to attention as pictures of the unnamed planet the group had stopped by to get crystals slid into view. “There we go.” Adora gestured to the pictures, pulling them up to display them before her.

A delicate silence slipped between the two of them, Adora regarded the pictures in horror. They looked far worse than she had thought. She didn’t turn around to see Wrong Hordak’s expression.

Adora sighed, resting her head against the cool surface of the chair she rested on, her breath leaving behind foggy mist against the shiny material.

“I cannot- He-”

Yeah, this was going to be a while.

***

Glimmer winced. Her legs felt like jelly and her brain screamed at her do just do *something* . Sitting up, she pulled the blankets around her and the warmth that clung to them as she shed them. She had been doing some basic stretches while she remained bedridden, but she has yet to actually take a step. Carefully, she positioned herself to have her legs hanging over the edge of the bed, just barely touching the floor through her toes.

She sucked in a breath at the coldness that greeted her, holding her breath to not shriek in surprise at the sensation. Gritting her teeth, she let more of her foot hit the cold ground, slowly moving until she stood up, her hand on the bed for support as her legs shook.

Carefully, Glimmer took a step forward, carefully, cautiously.

Using the wall as a support, Glimmer made her way around the room carefully, wincing at the cold that soaked her feet. Then, she stumbled, her legs hitting together as she stumbled. Her hand flung up to grip a nearby object, which just so happened to be the door's handle. She steadied herself, using her hands to balance her weight as she stood up again shakingly.

Taking a deep breath, Glimmer, peered into the hallway, glancing back and forth like her old days when she rebelled against her mother.

Leaning on the wall, Glimmer hissed at the coldness that greeted her. But she steeled herself against it, and kept walking forwards, leaning against the wall carefully.

Distantly, Glimmer heard noises from ahead of her. No footsteps, just voices. So whoever they were, they weren't walking.

(They weren't on patrol. She was safe.)

She stumbled again, her knees colliding with the hard ground and making a noise that caused Glimmer to freeze on instint.

(They didn't hear- please say they didn't- she couldn't be found- no, she was safe. They are her friends, not *him* .)

She let out a small pained gasp as she shoved herself up, using her hands to push herself away from the ground.

Gritting her teeth, Glimmer sucked in a breath between her teeth as she took a moment to stable herself and steady herself against the wall. With her hand pressed firmly on the wall, Glimmer started to stumble forwards steadily.

She fought against the pain that swam at the edges of her conciousness as she kept walking forwards steadily.

(One foot, then the other, then again. Repeat.. repeat…)

Soon enough (Not quick enough) Glimmer managed to stumble into the cockpit, where Bow instantly spotted her and rushed over to help Glimmer, who stubbornly refused it.

"N- no. I'm good Bow-" Glimmer grumbled as she leaned against the wall.

"No you are not! You shouldn't eben be up yet!" Bow exclaimed as he grabbed Glimmer's upper arms and hoisted her up.

"I'm just dead weight then-" Glimmer complained as she noticed Adora had moved her head from where she sat in the chair to stare at Glimmer. Catra laying sideways on Adora's lap.

"No you are not! You are recovering! There is a big difference there Glimmer!" Bow loudly proclaimed as he slowly walked with Glimmer over towards Adora and Catra.

Glimmer weakly followed, wincing as her muscles screamed at the movement.

"This feels more like being the weakest link than recovering." Glimmer complained as Bow led her over to stand next to Adora and Catra.

Catra pratically laid in Adora's lap like a blanket, even drooping herself so to appear as such. Her tail flicking lazily as she regarded Glimmer.

"What- what even are you two doing? Do I- want to know…?" Glimmer grumbled, her eyes flicking from Catra to Adora to Bow to Entrapta in the corner.
Catra smirked. "We're bothering Adora." Catra purred, her face a smug grin.

"Uh- why?"

"Because." Catra grinned showing off her fangs.

Glimmer glanced back at Bow in confusion, and Bow shrugged. "We were trying to help Adora go into She-Ra again."

"Ah. That makes sense."

Glimmer decided that right there, these moments, may point to be worth it.

(Wounds take time to heal, and Glimmer realized that. They all had their wounds. Only until this war was over could they begin to heal.)

Glimmer took a deep breath. "I need to tell you something."

Chapter End Notes

Okay, so I've decided that Imma share some notes with yall:

-Story goes on as same after this chapter, similar plot line except Glimmer is a bit more unsure, a bit more nervous during the Etheria battle arc.
-If you are confused on the ending, it was Glimmer going to be telling the gang about the other controlling bugs on Etheria.
-Entrapta is a bit more friend-ariented, but not funny converted. Her story arc still follows as it goes in the show.
-Bow and Swift Wind talks about forgiveness and friendship. (Forgiving Glimmer in this case and Bow's conflicting emotions.)
-And Finally, and not least, Catra is given a second chance by the alliance and stuff. Oh, she also gets a really badass theme song. (We can imagine it I promise.)

The Future

Chapter Summary

The gang get their happy ending.

Chapter Notes

I wanted to tell all of you, thank you for waiting. And I can now confidently say that I now have TWO fully finished multichapters done!

I might add more to this fandom, but I already have so many other fics to work on, and I hate leaving them empty.

May you enjoy this final chapter with me! <3
:D

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Adora! Make her stop!" Catra shrieked as she ducked behind Adora, her tail twisting behind her as Glimmer darted in with a brush firmly in her grip.

"No! You need to brush your hair!" Glimmer shouted as she ran laps around Adora chasing Catra.

Bow chuckled as he watched the two of them running around like kids. "Hello Adora."

Adora laughed. "Always us huh?"

Bow barked a laugh of surprise. "I guess so huh? That's what do for the people we love."

Love . Something that if you told Bow years ago, he would've sighed sadly and told you that the war was too dangerous to love. (Besides, denial and all of that.)

But now- watching as Glimmer chased Catra around, finally pinning the cat girl and dramatically raising the brush, Bow couldn’t help but smile warmly at the sight.

Glimmer had grown so much since Horde Prime. Obviously, that trauma is still there, but she had them to help her.

Catra shrieked as Glimmer ran the brush through the cat's hair, dragging her claws harmlessly against Glimmer's side as Catra yowled. (Since when could she yowl??)

Bow laughed, chuckling at the antics the two women displayed.

The dress Glimmer wore fell behind her like a shadow as she giggled. Two long, light purple strands fell behind her like a cape and her dress curled at the bottom like a fluffy cloud, changing to a light purple at the tips. Similar to her usual pink in color. Her eyes shone with a sparkle Bow had not seen in such a long time.

Catra wore a suit, purple in color. Pristene and smooth, her cuffs only rolled up at the edges and her hair a messy mess. (Huh- that sounded a lot better in Bow's head then outloud.)

Adora's hair was pinned in a neat bow as she shook her head in mock dissappointment.

"Seriously you two? You're acting like children! Perfuma's and Scorpia's Wedding is in an hour and you two are running around like kids!" Adora face palmed as her blue eyes peered at the two of them from behind her palms.

Bow laughed, as Adora straightened her own suit, rolling her eyes affectionectly at the sight.

"Adora-! You really need to keep your eyes on your girlfriend." Glimmer rolled her eyes, stepping away as Catra darted out and took cover behind Adora.

That only made Bow laugh even harder, wheezing almost as he clenched his stomach.

"Bow-! Stop laughing!" Glimmer pouted as she bounded up to him and pressed her palm against her forehead in a dramatic fasion. "I've been betrayed! Oh the horror!"

Glimmer laughed, sticking her tongue out cheerfully as Bow rolled his eyes.

"Oh stop it Glimmer." Bow playfully whacked Glimmer on the head.

"No attacking your queen!" Glimmer yelped, ducking her head. "Plus! I JUST got my hair done-!" She complained.

Bow chuckled, his voice deep as he laughed. "There there. I'm sure everything will be just fine your magesty." Bow patted Glimmer's head.

Glimmer pouted, her pink eyes sparkling as she crossed her arms and huffed. "Come on! We're going to be late to the wedding-!" Glimmer ran out, barely pausing to send a wink Catra's way before she darted out of the room.

Bow sighed tiredly. "Oh what am I going to do with her?"

"You have a handful there Arrow Boy." Catra smirked from behind Adora, she chuckled gleefully.

Bow sighed shaking his head fondly.

Catra chuffed as Bow left the room calling out to Glimmer.

"Hey Glimmer! Wait up-!" Bow called out as he hurried out of the room, his own suit carefully maniqued and pleasently fastened as he left.

Catra took two steps after the two of them, her ears twitched as she turned to stare at Adora. "Hey, are you coming with Adora?" Catra held a hand out towards Adora.

Smiling, Adora reached out and took her hand, ready to follow.

(Mermista and Sea Hawk arguing, Entrapta rambling to Hordak, Frosta talking animately with Kyle. Glimmer and Bow sobbing in the crowd with joy as Scorpia and Perfuma said their vows. Catra and Adora watching, smiling widely at their friends.)

Things got better, Glimmer could say.

(The nightmares never did, but she had her friends to help her.)

Time heals wounds, but not all wounds will stay closed.

(They were not alone. There was a whole universe to explore out there!)

Chapter End Notes

I JUST WANTED TO SAY A FEW THINGS!!

THANK YOU TippenFunkaport FOR THE 'SAVE THE ARCHER' FIC! I HIGHLY RECCOMEND CHECKING THAT OUT!!

THANK YOU ALSO TO BB Creative (BB_Creative0) FOR ALL OF YOUR COMMENTS AND YOUR NEW FRIENDSHIP! (This is my gift to you! <3)

Finally, Thank YOU for reading this fic. I hope this was enjoyable for you to read and I hope that your future is as bright as theirs.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!